

Bong Tour
A Masala Film

written by
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ACT 1

EXT. NEAR THE GANGES RIVER, WEST BENGAL, INDIA - AFTERNOON

Along the banks of the sacred Ganges river in West Bengal, we see a badly maimed and bloodied little person, MONTU, with an acid-scarred face, cradling what looks like a baby in his arms. Explosions are heard in the distance. sweat rolls down his dirty face. He finds a small basket, and carefully sets the thing most precious to him down. Going through remarkable physical pain and strain to do so, he uses his last strength to push the basket down the river, drawing allegory to Moses. A tear trickles down his face as he collapses along the shore.

The basket is dragged down the river, until it slowly starts to sink, unravelling the cloth and revealing THE BONG, which is slowly filled with the refuse of the sacred Ganges.

As the Bong disappears underwater, bubbles begin to fill the basin.

INTRO CREDITS

FADE IN:

INT. DREW'S VAN - SUNSET BOULEVARD - TRAVELING - DAY

We see the same bong (and potentially the same water) being used by two out of focus individuals. As a shaky handheld camera pulls back, we obtain focus on VISHAL, a stocky long-haired Indian man being force-fed a hit by his unkempt passenger: a blonde and scraggly fellow named DREW. They both look higher than the sky.

DREW

Oh man... if that one doesn't get
you to Middle Earth, I don't know
what will!

Vishal shudders as the smoke clears. His eyes are completely red. He looks outside his window and sees what initially appears to be a wizard with a large staff casting spells on the corner of the street. Upon further inspection, it's a homeless man. Vishal shakes his head like a dog and slaps his face to try and bring some sense back to himself.

VISHAL

Man... I don't know if I've ever
been this high.

DREW

Haha! This thing really is magic,
isn't it? Boy did we luck out!

Just then, outside of his van window, a motorcycle pulls up on what seems to Vishal to be a dragon. Vishal is terrified as he looks outside the driver's side window. The rider has the aspect of a ring wraith. Vishal is visibly shaken, until the rider pulls down their hood revealing a harmless young woman.

VISHAL

Oh my god. Wow. Man, Drew... maybe
we shouldn't pitch our movie in
this state.

DREW

California? C'mon man, the strike
is totally temporary! Literally,
not a big deal at all.

VISHAL

No! Drew. I mean *this* stoned. I'm
afraid we're about to go pitch *Bill
& Ted* meets *Lord of the Rings*!

DREW

Right! We are, my dude!

VISHAL

Oh man... I just... I think we were
high the entire time we wrote this.

Drew, in the passenger seat, packs another bowl into the bong and snaps it. Time seems to bend a bit behind his window --- he is unaware. We hear the Siri navigation randomly chime in from Vishal's phone.

SIRI

I'm sorry. You asked: "Were we high
the entire time we wrote it?"

VISHAL

Wait, did I just ask that?

DREW

(smoke still in his lungs)
Hell yeah, we were high! That's how
I know it's good. Besides, *Lord of
the Rings* is great man, we could be
compared to way worse movies!

VISHAL

I don't know that jamming in a hundred references to it is what's going to make our movie great though, you know?

DREW

They're subtle! Nobody is going to even notice. Plus, life is often exactly like the movies.

VISHAL

No it is not!

DREW

What are you talking about? Of course it is! It happens all the time! I'm talking random incidental quotes, structure, character arcs, all of it. Life is exactly like the movies **and** *Lord of the Rings* happens to be the best.

VISHAL

One: It's not the best. Two: You haven't even read the books!

DREW

I'm a method writer, Vishal, not a method reader. Give me a break, I mean, c'mon. Wanna hit this?

Drew empties his grinder into the bowl and extends the bong toward Vishal and begins lighting it for him. Vishal bends his head down to take a rip. He briefly has to take his eyes off the road, and mid-way through his pull, we hear a THUD. They have hit something with the van.

VISHAL

Shit, shit, shit!

DREW

(oblivious, finishing the
rip Vishal didn't entirely
clear)

Hot damn!

The van's hood pours out steam and is clearly in bad shape, but not as bad shape as the lanky man they have struck. Vishal opens up the van's driver-side door and weed smoke billows out, combining with the damaged vehicle's vapors. Drew catches up with reality and joins him. The men walk forward to see what/who they have struck.

To their surprise, a figure lunges out of the smoke toward them. They are terrified and immediately jump back into the van.

VISHAL

Oh my god, what do we do, what do we do?

DREW

What do you mean what do we do? We gotta drive, dude!

VISHAL

Wait... wait a minute...

As the smoke clears, their initial fear quickly subsides, however, as they realize that they are not seeing an orc or other fiend, but rather, a severely weakened and bloodied man in a motion-capture suit.

VISHAL (CONT'D)

Holy shit, did we kill somebody? I don't even have a license in the US, man. I don't want to go to prison.

DREW

Fuck me, I'll check it out.

Drew exits the car and disappears behind the smoke still billowing from the hood of the car. Suddenly, he is heard laughing.

DREW (CONT'D)

You're not gonna believe it, Vishal! It's Jack!

The smoke clears and Vishal sees Drew walking forward with their friend JACK flung over his shoulder. Vishal looks suddenly relieved.

VISHAL

Jack?! Oh wow, thank God, man.

Vishal and Drew look around nervously and share a relieved nod that nobody has seemed to have seen the accident, before Drew carelessly tosses Jack in through the side of the van.

In addition to the mo-cap suit, Jack has only one other item of clothing: a stud collar around his neck, with a leash attached to it. Drew looks around the scene of the crime while holding the end of the leash.

JACK
(in agony and confused
stupor)
Drew? Vishal?

DREW
(coyly)
Heh. Where's his owner?

VISHAL
Dude! Now is not the time for
comedy.

Jack succumbs to his injuries and passes out on the floor in the back of the van. Drew gives Jack a quick once-over, not inspecting anything with much depth.

DREW
Would you just relax, Vishal? He's fine. This is a normal day for Jack. If anything, this is really, really lucky.

VISHAL
What are you talking about, Drew?
How can this be lucky?

DREW
We're about to pitch our movie and our mo-cap suit came back to us dude! Just like that!

VISHAL
What about Jack, man? How's he gonna work?

Drew looks over his shoulder. Jack's limbs twitch slightly, which causes Drew to smile.

DREW
He'll be fine. He's a stalwart, this one.

Sirens are heard in the distance as neighboring houses' curtains ruffle with movement.

DREW (CONT'D)
Still... we should, erm... probably get off the road ASAP.

Vishal begins driving again and is clearly stressed. Drew lights up another bowl and blows smoke through the van, causing Vishal to be unable to see. Vishal attempts to turn on the windshield wipers in response.

VISHAL

I need to focus on driving man, can you just not, for a second? I'm way too fucking high right now.

DREW

(pointing at the Bong)
She packs a punch, huh?

VISHAL

This is all happening way too fast.

DREW

(pointing at the
speedometer)
Bro, you're doing like, 20 in a 45 right now.

VISHAL

It's still too fast.

DREW

You're gonna get us pulled over man, you're a brown guy driving suspicious as hell with a dead gay guy in your back seat right now!

VISHAL

Wait, is he dead?!? You said he was fine!

Vishal speeds up out of sheer nervousness. Drew slaps Jack on the face. Jack is not particularly responsive to it.

DREW

(checking Jack's pulse)
I don't think he'll be joining us much further along on this journey, I'll just say that much.

VISHAL

Oh my God... I never should have left India. Are we bad people, Drew?

DREW

No worse than the average mid-Americans, Vishal! We're just slaves to the art... and sometimes? Well, there's not that much to laugh about, okay? Hey, look! There's the Comedy Store up there on the right.

Vishal pulls off of Sunset Blvd. into the parking lot.

VISHAL
Oh, thank the Gods.

Vishal begins kissing the steering wheel and dashboard as Drew looks back at the collapsed body in their van.

DREW
(unbuckling his seatbelt
with anticipation)
So. We should probably get that
motion capture suit off of Jack,
right?

Vishal looks back over his shoulder in dread and unbuckles his seatbelt as well.

DREW (CONT'D)
Right?

FLASHBACK TO:

INT. BASEMENT - MORNING

We see a cutaway of a set that is a 1:1 copy of the set from *That 70s Show*. Five people surround the room in various positions. Smoke dances around the room and it is clear we are joining them after some time smoking already.

Vishal is leaning back on one of the two chairs in the room, looking incredibly faded. Drew leans back in the other chair, staring blankly into space. Across from them on the couch, Vishal's cousin RAHUL sits next to his soon-to-be wife JANVHI. Filling the couch's last seat is WILLIE, a spunky, intelligent, red-haired woman that is a spitting image of Hermione Granger.

On the table are various items of weed paraphernalia and the high-art synonymous with the culture of their time: An ash tray with a roach, a pizza box (that may or not have pizza still inside it), some napkins with stick figure drawings of what appear to be little people wielding swords, and similarly crude renderings of horses.

We see JANVHI being offered a what looks to be a smoothie by VISHAL.

VISHAL
Bhang Lassi?

JANVHI

No, I don't want to get **too** high.
 (looks toward Rahul)
 You remember last time, right?

RAHUL

(defensively)
 Oh, come on! Really? Do you see any
 horses around here?

JANVHI (ASIDE)

(to Rahul, with force)
 Nay! Hoge. Bas!

Vishal gives the soon-to-be domesticated Rahul a look of
 pity, and begins pouring some bhang for himself.

JANVHI (CONT'D)

(to the group, trying to
 steer the conversation
 toward loftier pursuits)
 Anyway, as we were saying --- we
 can't wait for all of you to join
 us for our wedding in India.

While Janvhi speaks, Rahul surreptitiously begins handling
 Drew's glass of bhang. Drew notices and initially resists,
 but Rahul holds a finger to his lips with a nod toward his
 wife, signaling for Drew to not blow his cover.

WILLIE

Oh! I can't wait to go! I'm so
 happy for you both. I've always
 wanted to attend an Indian
 wedding... and Vishal's told me so
 much about India. I can't wait.

RAHUL

(chortling)
 Vishal's told you about India, has
 he?

Rahul quickly hurls an insult in Hindi to his younger cousin.
 Drew looks on in awe as he is the sole witness to Rahul
 pouring the Bhang lassi into the basin of the bong. Drew and
 Rahul share a knowing smile.

RAHUL (CONT'D)

Bandar kya adrakjaane ka swaad?

SUBTITLES

What does a monkey know of the
 taste of ginger?

VISHAL

Hey!

DREW (ASIDE)

(to Janvhi)

What'd he say?

JANVHI (ASIDE)

He called him a monkey and made him think twice about that monkey's relationship with ginger.

Drew is confused, but nods, pretending to understand.

DREW

I'm gonna need subtitles or something if you guys are gonna do the Hindi thing.

RAHUL

Willie... If you want to *really* see India, Vishal is *not* the guy to show it to you. He's one of the whitest Indians I know.

VISHAL

What?! That's not true!

RAHUL

When was the last time you visited the motherland? I bet you can't even handle a bit of masala anymore.

VISHAL

Well, my tolerance may not be what it once was, but...

RAHUL

When's the last time you had some chai from some peddler off the road, hm? Or called a random stranger your Uncle?

VISHAL

Well, I...

RAHUL

Or honked at a cow or paid off a transvestite who cut you off in an intersection?

JANVHI
 (shocked)
 Is *that* what India is to you?

RAHUL
 (impassioned, swept off
 into monologue)
 And how many times have you had to
 fire a maid for poisoning your
 water or for stealing your mother-
 in-law's spoons?

JANVHI
 (suddenly, with enthusiasm)
 Oh! She was such a bitch.

RAHUL
 Or found yourself lost, questioning
 the meaning of it all --- eating
chole bhature and biryani made of
 street-dog at a railway station at
 six in the morning while watching
 the rickshaw drivers urinate?

Janvhi looks with grave concern at Rahul and seems to be re-
 considering the wedding.

WILLIE
 I'm not sure I'm as excited about
 India as I was a few minutes ago.

VISHAL
 (to Willie)
 Yeah, see? This is kind of the
 stuff that makes me not so eager to
 go back.

RAHUL
 You want to know what it is really
 like to be a Desi, Vishal? Look at
 this...

Rahul stands and begins handing the bong to Drew, hesitates,
 and rips the bong viciously again before making the handoff
 official.

Rahul suddenly unbuttons his shirt, and as the smoke from his
 hit fades, a set of MASSIVE SCARS along his chest is
 revealed.

JANVHI
 (burying her head in her
 hands)
 (MORE)

JANVHI (CONT'D)
Not the scar story, Rahul,
please...

RAHUL
(with pride)
Last Holi, I had to fight off a
gang of possessed monkeys with a
cricket bat. They tried to steal my
Bhang. Over my dead body.

Rahul stamps his foot. Janvhi looks embarrassed.

RAHUL (CONT'D)
Where is your cricket bat, Vishal?
Have you taken your practice swings
yet today? You never know when you
will need to fight off a wild
street animal with your cricket
bat.

Vishal looks down in shame.

VISHAL
I don't have one.

RAHUL
You see, Willie? If you want to
survive India, don't let these guys
plan your trip. They'll probably
end up getting you trafficked.

VISHAL
We're not gonna get her trafficked!

Willie looks up at Janvhi for support.

JANVHI
(to Rahul)
Don't scare her.

VISHAL
(to Willie)
Don't worry, we'll have a driver
with us everywhere we go.

RAHUL
Which is great, unless he's the one
who's doing the trafficking, of
course.

JANVHI
(snapping)
Rahul!

RAHUL

What! I'm just worried, that's all.
Look at him. America has made him
soft.

VISHAL

Hey! I've been surviving in Los
Angeles for the last five years.
It hasn't exactly been... easy for
me either.

DREW

(nodding in encouragement
at his friend)
You've done well, buddy. Lots of
sacrifices, that's for sure.

RAHUL

And? Other than losing your sense
of tradition and culture, what do
you have to show for it?

VISHAL

Well...

Vishal stops to think for a few seconds and is struggling to
come up with an answer.

DREW

(helpfully)
You got those casting credits in
Jack's one-off last year.

VISHAL

(shushing Drew)
I can't use those anywhere.

RAHUL

Huh?

DREW

And we have *Bhang Tour*.

VISHAL

Yeah, we do have *Bhang Tour*.

JANVHI

What's *Bhang Tour*?

WILLIE

That's the name of their life's
work! Hasn't Vishal told you about
it?

DREW
It's a Bollywood movie!

VISHAL
(bashful)
Dhollywood, technically, Drew...
the story happens in Bangladesh.

RAHUL
Oh, Vishal, Vishal. You are writing
a *Dhollywood* movie? Oh, that's
rich.

DREW
It's an epic.

RAHUL
(laughing skeptically)
I bet! I bet it is.

DREW
Think Stoner Comedy --- but gritty.
Apocalypse Now. Copola sort of
stuff.

VISHAL
Drew! Careful man, people might
think we mean Sofia...

WILLIE
Hey! Her directing wasn't bad.

DREW
You know we're not talking about
her directing, Willie.

Drew and Vishal shoot a look of obvious reprimand to Willie.
Willie glares back.

RAHUL
(chortling, holding back
tears)
Right! Well then! Tell me what
you've got! Hopefully it's not just
some Franco-Rogan ripoff. I have
standards. *High* standards.

Drew and Vishal share a nervous look.

VISHAL
It's really not ready to share with
people yet.

RAHUL

(offended)

What? I'm not 'people', I'm your cousin! Come on, just give me the pitch.

VISHAL

It's just kind of hard to explain without having a mo-cap suit.

RAHUL

(confused)

Wait, a what?

JANVHI

What's a mo-cap suit?

DREW

You know, a motion capture suit? Like the one they put on the guy who played Gollum.

JANVHI

Gollum?

DREW

From *Lord of The Rings*?

JANVHI

I know who Gollum is... I didn't know somebody wore a suit for that.

Drew holds up his phone to Janvhi and Rahul. His home background is set to a picture of Andy Serkis wearing a motion-capture suit on-set during the *Lord of The Rings* production.

DREW

Of course they did. How else would they do that?

JANVHI

I guess I didn't give it enough thought.

DREW

Oh, the suit is everything.

RAHUL

Well, let's get the suit out then!

VISHAL

We don't have it right now.

RAHUL
No?

VISHAL
Unfortunately.

RAHUL
Where is it?

VISHAL
Not here, man.

RAHUL
Not here?

VISHAL
You know, it's elsewhere.

RAHUL
So you just aren't gonna tell me
about the movie unless you have the
suit?

DREW
Vishal's right. We can't put the
cart before the horse here. I'm
sorry, we'll have to pitch it to
you later man.

BACK TO PRESENT:

DREW (CONT'D)
(echoes over dark screen)
Later, Man... Later, man...

INT. VISHAL'S VAN - SUNSET BOULEVARD - STATIONARY - DAY

Vishal and Drew crawl into the back of the van and begin prying at the suit, which has a very snug fit against Jack's body. Jack groans as their fingers prod at his body.

DREW
Fuck yeah! Our pitch was gonna go
nowhere without this suit.

VISHAL
Dude... who cares about the movie
man? Look at Jack! He needs a
doctor, Drew. He's in pretty bad
shape...

DREW

Jack *always* needs a doctor, Vishal. I'm telling you, don't let this first-act character become a distraction. The movie is all that matters! Sacrifices must be made man... Remember Boromir?

VISHAL

Not everybody is just some character in our script!

DREW

Exactly! Jack is not going to be joining us from here on out, okay? He's served his purpose. Think of him less as a person, and more of a narrative device.

VISHAL

What the fuck are you saying man? Served his purpose? Getting hit by our fucking van? What about karma, man?

DREW

There's no such thing.

VISHAL

Of course there is!

DREW

(with nonchalance)

Well... then this is good karma for Jack, right? I mean, he's helping us out big time.

VISHAL

Well. That's one way of looking at it.

DREW

Just look at how zen he looks, hm?

Jack's breathing has slowed drastically, but a small smile has crossed his face.

VISHAL

Yeah, I guess so... but what about us?

DREW

It's good karma for us too! Who better to have hit Jack than his friends, right? Could have been a total stranger. Could have been a bunch of junkies with no moral compasses. I mean, we're not robbing him, you know?

VISHAL

Yeah, I guess you're right.

Drew grunts as he rips the last of the mo-cap suit off of Jack's immobile body. Jack groans as they rip off the suit.

DREW

Just think about it Vishal, if we or Jack had bad karma, don't you think somebody else would have hit him?

VISHAL

Hm. I guess so.

DREW

Here, put this on.

Drew tosses the mo-cap suit over to Vishal, who begins dressing somewhat haphazardly.

DREW (CONT'D)

Listen, I know I've never told you this Vishal, and it might seem a bit weird to you, but... Jack didn't want to stay working in the industry forever.

VISHAL

No?

DREW

And I'm not just some key grip or stage hand either, man, I've paid my dues! But... you know, Hollywood doesn't always see it that way. *Bhang Tour* is kind of my ticket out, man. I need this. I believe in it.

VISHAL

You do?

DREW

Of course I do, man. It's way better than anything else I have going for me.

Drew motions generally toward Jack's body, sprawled out in the van.

DREW (CONT'D)

Now... this situation we've method-written ourselves into, it's unimportant. It's just a minor obstacle. We need to move onto the rising action.

VISHAL

(looking at Jack's bloodied, naked body)
Maybe we should at least bring him into the Comedy Store to get cleaned up, huh?

DREW

No, man. Think about how that would look? Hauling a near-corpse into the comedy club? Nothing funny about that, man.

DREW (CONT'D)

(sighing)
We gotta leave him. We're on our own journey, now, man. Just like Sam & Frodo.

VISHAL

So we just leave him here, naked like this?

DREW

Look, Vishal, Jack here is like the Shire to us. The life we came from, boring, predictable, safe.

(pointing at Jack, still in a fetal position)
And I feel that as long as Jack lies behind, safe and... comfortable, we shall find our wander more bearable.

DREW (CONT'D)

Man, it's times like these I'm glad you know me, Vishal. You're a talented cat, but man, I've still gotta show you the ropes.

Vishal nods in agreement as he finishes putting on the motion-capture suit. He frowns as he realizes Drew was being somewhat literal in his last statement, as Drew begins to tie Jack's leash to part of the van's interior.

VISHAL
You're tying him up?

DREW
A good screenwriter leaves no loose ends, Vishal.

VISHAL
But...

DREW
(cinching the knot tight
around Jack's collar)
Just, don't worry about a thing,
buddy. We're gonna be jussssst fine.
It's not like all of this just
happened to us by accident.
Remember?

FLASHBACK TO:

INT. BASEMENT - MORNING

Rahul looks toward Willie confusedly for some sort of validation that he is reading and grasping the situation correctly.

RAHUL
Do they *really* need the suit? Now I
actually want to know what the
movie is about.

WILLIE
To be honest, it does make a lot
more sense when they explain it
with the suit.

A short awkward silence occurs.

RAHUL
So they do *have* a suit.

VISHAL
(seeming bothered, wanting
to change the topic)
We have a suit sometimes. But it's
not here right now.

Another short awkward silence occurs. Rahul tries asking Drew instead, hoping the change of direction will prove fruitful.

RAHUL
Oh... Where is it?

DREW
It's with our friend Jack currently.

JANVHI
Who is Jack?

VISHAL
He's our friend.

DREW
He's a video artist.

JANVHI
Are you guys part of a filmmaking group or something?

VISHAL
Not really...

DREW
More like a syndicate, really.

JANVHI
That's so cool! What kind of stuff do you guys work on?

A short pause ensues. Vishal suddenly looks wildly uncomfortable.

VISHAL
Nothing!

DREW
(a beat after Vishal)
Adult films.

JANVHI
Wait... What?

Vishal puts his head in his hands.

DREW
Yep. Jack's probably cementing his legacy in the storied annals of West Hollywood at this very moment.

JANVHI
I see.

VISHAL
I don't want to think about it.

DREW

I'm sure it's fine, Vishal. He said he was only using the mo-cap suit for some footage of his dog.

VISHAL

I told you, man, I don't want to think about it!

Rahul looks forward in a mix of confusion and disappointment and twiddles his thumbs a bit, sensing he should break the awkwardness now surrounding the room.

RAHUL

The *Lord of the Rings*, though. Those were pretty good movies, hm?

VISHAL

They were alright.

DREW

(suddenly impassioned)
Alright?! What are you talking about, man? Phenomenal movies. Tell Vishal, Willie. Phenomenal. Right, Willie?

WILLIE

I think I watch film for different reasons than you Drew, but yes, I did like those movies.

RAHUL

Well? There's your target then, Vishal. You have to ask yourself. Will *Bhang Tour* ever measure up to *Lord of The Rings*?

VISHAL

Wait, what? *Lord of the Rings*? What are you guys going on about? We're not writing fan-fiction here. We're not trying to measure up to anything. *Bhang Tour* is its own thing. It has to be authentic... I need my viewers to see the reality my characters see. I need them to taste the sorrows they taste, feel what they feel, suffer how they suffer. For I am forged from the Bhang and the Bong is forged from me.

RAHUL

I think I may very well be onto my
next life by the time I find out
what this movie is about.

Janvhi senses that Rahul is beginning to strike a nerve, and
steps in.

JANVHI

(supportively)

I'm sure it's going to be wonderful
when it's done!

WILLIE

Hey... they really have come a long
way. Their fifteenth revision of
the outline is an improvement.

DREW

That's right! Getting there ---
little by little. Just a few teensy
tiny character details we have to
work out.

VISHAL

Right, we can't afford to think
small here.

Drew walks toward the bong, picks it up off the table, and
smiles like an idiot.

DREW

(pointing at the Bong)

I don't think any of us are gonna
be thinking small with this awesome
fucking bong in our inventory.

Drew goes to take a rip but we hear the weed get sucked
through. He comes up empty.

DREW (CONT'D)

Ah man! It's cashed. Vishal, can we
load up another?

VISHAL

Actually...

RAHUL

(interrupting)

Listen... you guys. No matter what
happens with the movie. Just... Be
careful with that *Bhang*, alright?
It gets you too fucking high, man.
I'm telling you.

(MORE)

RAHUL (CONT'D)
 You don't want to wake up one day
 in a barren field in the Greater
 Area of Bangladesh regretting the
 choices you've made.

Janvhi gives a comforting shoulder pat to Rahul, who has a sudden look of remorse and shame streak across his face.

JANVHI (ASIDE)
 (to Rahul)
 We should get going, honey.

JANVHI (ASIDE) (CONT'D)
 (to Willie)
 You gonna be okay, sweetheart?

WILLIE
 (smiling)
 I think I'll survive.

Rahul stands up to leave and joins Janvhi, before turning toward the remaining stoners.

RAHUL
 And Vishal, Drew --- if you guys
 break my bong? Well, I'll do to you
 what I did to that monkey.

Rahul sends a suddenly menacing look toward Drew & Vishal, and then continues to have a discreet conversation while approaching the staircase to exit.

As soon as Rahul and Janvhi have left, Willie is suddenly alert:

WILLIE
 Is this trip going to be safe for
 me, guys?

VISHAL
 Relax, Willie, he has no idea what
 is he talking about.

DREW
 (mostly to himself)
 Should we load another bowl?

Drew begins fidgeting around the items on the table, looking for weed.

WILLIE
 Kind of sounds like he knew exactly
 what he was talking about. Did you
 see that scar?

DREW
Can we load another bowl, guys?
Where's the weed at?

DREW (CONT'D)
(with overboiling
frustration)
Guys, have you seen the fucking
weed anywhere?

Drew begins tossing things around more aggressively, trying to find the grass, with increasing frustration. In his frustration the Bong starts to wobble, causing Vishal duress.

VISHAL
DUDE. The BONG!

Vishal dives like a Bollywood action hero in slow motion –
– and catches it midair, cradling it like a newborn baby. A single drop of Bhang hits the floor with a tiny splash.
He exhales, wide-eyed.

VISHAL (CONT'D)
(breathless, cradling the
bong)
That was nearly the end of
all things.

DREW
Dude, seriously – do we have any
more weed?

VISHAL
Oh, I turned the last of it into
bhang this morning.

DREW
Are you fucking serious?

Vishal nods with a stupid smile to Drew's disappointment.

DREW (CONT'D)
How the fuck are we gonna use the
bong, man?

VISHAL
I didn't know Rahul was bringing
the bong over!

DREW

How could you not at least leave us
some reserves, bro? It's common
sense!

VISHAL

I *did* leave reserves, that's what
we just smoked. That bong is super
inefficient.

DREW

(angry, impassioned)

What do you mean super inefficient?
Are you sure you don't mean, super
fucking awesome?!?

VISHAL

I... I...

DREW

(stammering and beginning
to cry a bit)

I can't believe you would do this
to us! You're pulling off a real
Jack here, man.

Drew slams the bong on the table and begins to toss some of
the screenplay notes from the table around the room.

DREW (CONT'D)

God damn it!

VISHAL

Drew! Stop! We worked hard on those
drawings, man!

Vishal runs toward the papers and begins re-ordering them
like a proud mother would.

WILLIE

Guys! Enough! Okay? Drew! Calm
down. Let's just order some more?
Open your phone, okay?

DREW

(sniffling)

Okay.

Drew types in 0420 for his password.

WILLIE

Alright, what are we after?

Willie opens up an app from a weed delivery service called *Get Grassed* and flips through the interface like a professional killer.

WILLIE (CONT'D)
Oh, Krishna Kush look at that.
Ganesh Berry. Shiva Skunk. --

DREW
(still sniffing)
Wait, what's with all the Indian strains?

WILLIE
We're in Little Bangladesh. The app makes recommendations based on location.

DREW
Well, turn off location services!

VISHAL
(muttering to himself)
Those all sounded good to me.

Willie hands the phone back to Drew.

WILLIE
And... there ya go!

Drew's eyes go wide with sticker shock. He is visibly shook by the price.

DREW
Oh my God...

DREW (CONT'D)
Are you guys gonna... chip in, or what?

VISHAL
I'm kind of out of money right now.

WILLIE
I'll have to get you back later down the road.

DREW
Seriously? Man, if this screenplay doesn't pan out, I am never going to financially recover from this.

VISHAL

It's like Jack always says --- we
can't put a price on inspiration.

DREW

It says it's a four hour wait...

WILLIE

(shaking her head)

Oh man, you guys are not gonna make
it.

VISHAL

(spoken like a prophet)

Drew, we can temper any storm. We
have the power of the Bhang.

DREW

(nodding, sniffing a bit
while regaining his
composure)

You know what? Alright. Alright.
You're right. To the power of the
Bhang!

Finding strength in their shared addiction, both men grab
their lassis, cheers one another, and take ceremonious swigs
from their bhang lassis.

WILLIE

Really, you guys?

VISHAL

How about we just put on another
Bollywood classic, and by the time
it's done, the weed will be here
and this pain you are feeling will
all be a thing of the past. How's
that sound, Drew?

DREW

Not sure I have much of a choice,
hm?

A quick time lapse occurs. The group's Bhang lassis resemble
sand hour-glasses as they drain and refill several times. We
see accelerated action of the film in the reflection of the
protagonists glassy-eyes. Drew's eyes are suddenly completely
dry and red, as he has stopped blinking entirely. They look
like they're about to fall out of his skull.

DREW (CONT'D)
 (stretching, yawning)
 Fuckin. Fuck. Pause, pause, pause!

Vishal pauses the movie. Drew begins rubbing his eyes as though he has allergies.

VISHAL
 What's up man?

DREW
 Guys, how is this movie not over yet?

VISHAL
 What do you mean?

DREW
 We have been watching this for hoursss.

We go to slow motion for enough time to hear Drew's voice echo multiple times. We zoom in on his lips in progressively slower motion.

DREW (V.O.)
 Hourrrrrrrrs... Hourrrrrrrrrrrrs.

We suddenly cut back to normal speed.

DREW (CONT'D)
 What is with all these Indian movies, man, are they all this long?

VISHAL
 Only the good ones.

WILLIE
 Do we *have* to have three songs in ours?

VISHAL
 No, just one really good one.

DREW
 I'm not sure I can finish this movie.

Vishal and Willie look over at Drew, who is rubbing his eyes ferociously, trying to get them to work again.

DREW (CONT'D)
 I just... I hate subtitles, man. I can't do it anymore.

Willie shakes her head.

VISHAL

Don't worry, we'll only use them
for comedic effect in our work.

DREW

Is this really necessary?

VISHAL

Drew, this is important! We have to
know our shit if we're going to be
known as the next Salim & Javed.

Drew looks back at Vishal, confused, but nods in resigned
agreement when he sees the joy the mention of the names seems
to cause Vishal.

WILLIE

Why Salim & Javed?

VISHAL

They're famous in India.

WILLIE

No, I know who they are. *Sholay*,
Don, all the classics. Who do you
think I am?

VISHAL

(smiling, adoringly)
That's why you're our editor.

WILLIE

(to Vishal, a bit
accusatory)
So, WHY Salim & Javed?

VISHAL

What do you mean?

WILLIE

There are three of us and you only
mentioned two people.

VISHAL

Oh, well... I just thought...

WILLIE

You just thought the woman didn't
need to be given credit, just the
men, is that right?

VISHAL

That's not what I meant... I...

WILLIE

Whatever. Just unpause the movie.

The three protagonists continue watching the scene in *Lagaan* in which a crippled Indian man bowls the heroes to victory in a cricket match against the British. As the final ball hits the wicket, Vishal pauses the action and approaches the television in excitement.

VISHAL

(pointing at the screen)

You see that? Redemption in the face of life's cruel and unfair circumstances. A moment when you think things might just finally be worth it. That's what Bhang Tour needs to be for people.

Willie grabs the remote and pauses the tv. She points toward it.

WILLIE

Just an observation... the movie we just watched... compared to what you've shown me so far...

Willie points at the screenplay notes and pages that Drew has tossed about the floor.

WILLIE (CONT'D)

Seems like a very well thought out, serious movie. I'm not sure we're even close to their level.

DREW

Ah, c'mon! You can't compare the two. We're going to be known as the first people to do a Dhollywood-Hollywood crossover, for Christ's Sake. It doesn't get much more serious than that, Willie.

Vishal smiles and walks over to the fourth, un-shown wall (that 70s show).

VISHAL

Willie, have you seen the latest changes we made? We took your last round of feedback to heart. I think you'll find this version has a lot more depth.

Vishal pulls away a large Indian tapestry that has been covering the wall. A whiteboard rests behind it.

DREW

You're gonna love it. It starts right in the middle of the action...

FADE TO:

INT. VISHAL'S VAN - SUNSET BOULEVARD - PARKED - DAY

Drew is seen cleaning up Vishal's mo-cap suit, tidying its rather rough appearance. Jack is still naked and chained. Vishal looks down at Jack with pity.

VISHAL

Hey Drew... don't you... think we should at least smoke Jack out? I hate leaving him like this. I'm pretty sure that's what he'd want.

DREW

You know what? You're right. We totally should. Let's load the bong. Jackie boy! You want some of this?

Drew nudges Jack's arm with his foot. It's totally limp.

DREW (CONT'D)

So... I mean, he's kind of incapacitated here... are we... shotgunning it to him, or what?

VISHAL

No, man! Consent! I was thinking we should just hot box the van one more time.

DREW

Oh, right! Consent! Alright, then! How's that sound, Jack? Wanna get second hand high?

Jack's thumb suddenly raises, reminiscent of the Terminator's death knell action in *Judgment Day*.

DREW (CONT'D)

Atta boy!

VISHAL
Do you still have more of that
Krishna Kush from earlier?

DREW
Earlier?

Drew loads up another fat bowl, rips it, and the smoke takes
Vishal & Drew to a flashback.

DREW (V.O) (CONT'D)
(echoing)
Earlier? Earlier?

FLASHBACK TO:

EXT. LITTLE BANGLADESH, LOS ANGELES, A SUBURBAN HOUSE - NOON

Willie is seen leaving the house as we zoom in upon it.
Shortly after her exit, we see a haggard, grizzled formerly-
famous actor, a bonafied C-LISTER, holding a big brown bag
and wearing a uniform that reads *Get Grassed*. He knocks upon
the door.

Vishal and Drew open the door, holding Bhang lassis. Their
red eyes and blank reactions show they are clearly baked out
of their minds.

THE C-LISTER
Got your order here fellas... good
choices. I love me some of that
Ganja Ganesh!

VISHAL
(stammering, with puppy-dog
eyes)
Holy shit. Aren't you the guy
from... shit, what was that movie
again?

THE C-LISTER
Yeah, it's me. Hey, listen, guys --
- it's hotter than the devil's dick
out here, and I got wicked cotton
mouth, can I get some water?

The C-Lister forcefully pushes the bag into Vishal's arms and
steps in essentially uninvited. He walks to the kitchen and
begins guzzling water from the sink like there is no
tomorrow.

DREW (ASIDE)
 (whispering)
 Who the hell is this guy? Should I
 know him?

VISHAL (ASIDE)
 I think he was a famous actor, like
 thirty years ago. I can't put my
 finger on it. He's definitely semi-
 famous though.

THE C-LISTER
 (still licking the water
 off his lips and licking
 up any water that fell
 upon his person)
 Fuckkk, man, it had been days!

Vishal looks unsure of the man, but Drew has become visibly
 excited. They wait, unsure of what is appropriate to do next.

To their surprise, the C-Lister plops down on the couch and
 begins eating out of a bowl of peanuts, leaving a horrible
 mess of shells. He puts his dirty shoes up onto a coffee
 table. Vishal begins to frown.

THE C-LISTER (CONT'D)
 Careful with that Krishna Khush,
 broskis. They should call it Munchy
 Mania.

VISHAL
 Hey... um... can't remember your
 name... listen... we were kind of
 in the middle of something, is
 there anything else we can do for
 you, man?

THE C-LISTER
 Oh sorry bro, I didn't mean to
 interrupt. I just thought you'd do
 the right thing and smoke out your
 delivery guy.

VISHAL
 Man, I really don't mean to be
 rude... but...

THE C-LISTER
 (quickly)
 So don't be. I live off of tips and
 rips these days, bro. It's the
 least you could do. Should do, I
 mean.

VISHAL

It's just, we're just in the middle of working on something...

THE C-LISTER

Oh, well don't let me stop you! I know my way around a bong. Don't need to be baby-sat. Say... you do have a bong for me to use, right? Nothing else works for me... It's a tolerance thing.

DREW

Of course we do!

VISHAL (ASIDE)

(with concern)

Dude, what are you doing? My cousin entrusted us with that Bong. What if he breaks it?

DREW (ASIDE)

Vishal, dude. You always get caught up on the small stuff. This guy is a famous actor, which means he knows famous directors. What if this is our lucky break? Maybe he'll like our screenplay?

THE C-LISTER

(overhearing and inching closer, creepily)

Screenplay, you say? Oh, now you have me intrigued.

VISHAL

I don't know...

DREW

Come on, man!

Vishal pulls Drew away from the C-Lister and begins whispering.

VISHAL (ASIDE)

It's not ready, dude! Plus, this guy, look man --- he is delivering weed now. He's washed up. Do you really think he's going to be able to help us?

DREW (ASIDE)

Oh come on, what is the worst that can happen?

VISHAL (ASIDE)
(angry sarcasm)
What if he steals our movie?

Drew puts a hand on Vishal's shoulder and gives him a reassuring look.

DREW
Come on, bro. That's what the law exists for. You really think people just go around stealing features in this town?

VISHAL
(quietly, to Drew)
I just... I don't know... what about the parts with the mo-cap suit? I don't feel like those are prime-time yet.

DREW
Forget about the mo-cap suits for a minute, you are always hung up on the weirdest shit. We don't even need mo-cap suits in this movie, honestly.

VISHAL
You were the one who was insisting on them!

As if sensing their reluctance, The C-Lister gives an "Ahem" cough and chimes in:

THE C-LISTER
I have powerful connections in Hollywood, maybe I could help you out, mmm?

Drew raises his eyebrows and smiles toward Vishal in self-righteous satisfaction.

VISHAL (ASIDE)
(sighs)
Fine. Come downstairs with us.

INT. BASEMENT - CONTINUOUS

The C-Lister is led downstairs by the two writers.

On the long table closest to the camera, the bong appears to be suddenly glowing with elvish inscriptions as the light bounces off its golden trim. The C-Lister's eyes widen as he approaches it.

THE C-LISTER

Woah, you guys! This Bong is just something else! Crazy stuff. What does that inscription say?

DREW

It's Hindi, isn't it?

VISHAL

Not that I can read Hindi... but it looks more like Urdu or something to me. Haven't seen these letters before.

THE C-LISTER

Hindi, Urdu, Elvish, who gives a shit? Let's get this bowl loaded and then we can look over your screenplay. Let's make some magic happen, fellas!

Vishal begins methodically grinding weed with his fingers. He starts out being conservative with the payload, but each time he is ready to consider the bowl ready to go, he hears a cough and receives a dissatisfied look from the C-Lister, beckoning for more weed to be added before the demanded courtesy will be considered fulfilled.

After several coughs, the bowl is overflowing and this causes The C-Lister to grin with satisfaction.

THE C-LISTER (CONT'D)

(in exaggerated awe)

The bowl overfloweth.

Vishal hands the bong to The C-Lister, who takes a deep breath, performing what appears to be some light yoga stretches before grabbing a lighter nearby. He is cool and controlled in his motion, until suddenly, he viciously snaps the entire bowl all in one go like a seasoned professional junkie.

DREW

Holy shit!

VISHAL

(with anger)

Dude, that was for all of us! Puff, puff pass, man!

THE C-LISTER
Fuckkkkkk!

Drew and Vishal initial surprise gives way to a look both of both disgust and shock.

VISHAL (ASIDE)
All weed-i-quette has been
violated.

THE C-LISTER
(through tears)
Dudes, you gotta change that bong
water.

The C-Lister starts to cough a horrible phlegmy cough and then tries to control it by clearing his throat. It is truly disgusting.

THE C-LISTER (CONT'D)
(coughing horribly)
Sorry fellas, it's a chronic
condition.

THE C-LISTER (CONT'D)
(still hacking, pointing at
the white board hung on
the wall)
Is that the movie?

DREW
You know it!

VISHAL
Well.. that's the outline. The
actual script is... well, kinda
right here in front of you.

VISHAL vaguely moves his hand, gesturing toward a bunch of papers still strewn about the floor, which appear to be covered in crude drawings of little people, swords, tuk-tuks, and horses with question marks above them.

DREW
So, the movie is set half in
Hollywood, half in Dhollywood.

THE C-LISTER
What the fuck is Dhollywood?

VISHAL
Like Bollywood, but Bangladeshi.

THE C-LISTER sighs and looks down.

THE C-LISTER
 Oh man, this is already confusing
 the shit out of me guys.

THE C-LISTER (CONT'D)
 (still wheezing,
 interrupting)
 Listen... I am more of a
 kinesthetic learner. Can you act it
 out for me? Also...

The C-LISTER gestures toward the now cashed bowl.

THE C-LISTER (CONT'D)
 We should load another before we
 start, yeah?

INT. BASEMENT MONTAGE - CONTINUOUS (SET TO EPIC MUSIC)

The three men are sitting cross legged in front of the whiteboard with a heading that reads *BHANG TOUR*. Smoke is still trailing off the Bong like incense. All of their eyes are historically red.

The shot pulls away from The C-Lister's drooping and slack-jawed face as he looks toward Vishal and Drew as they mime & act out various scenes as outlined crudely on the whiteboard.

The C-Lister is shown laughing hysterically, still intermittently hacking and grabbing at his sides.

At one point, the boys are seen panicking - performing CPR to revive the C-Lister, before things return back to normal the very next shot. Was it part of the screenplay? We can't know for sure.

Finally, Vishal and Drew are seen walking on their knees while carrying sticks in order to imitate little people fighting with swords. After the action concludes, one of them appears to be fatally wounded.

We see The C-Lister's put his fingers to his chin, pondering, nodding... slowly increasing in understanding until ---
 Eureka!

INT. BASEMENT - CONTINUOUS (MONTAGE & MUSIC ENDS)

THE C-LISTER
 I love it! Wow, wow, wow! It's like
 every classic movie ever, combined.
Epic. Epic. You guys ready for some
 notes?

Drew nods eagerly. Vishal is sweating profusely, having exerted himself to exhaustion during the swashbuckling scenes.

THE C-LISTER (CONT'D)
Hey, hearing about your screenplay
was the first five bowls. Notes are
extra.

Drew looks at their dwindling supply with dismay.

VISHAL
Oh, just pay the man.

DREW
But...

VISHAL
You can't put a price on
inspiration, Drew.

Another bowl is loaded. Vishal sighs as he passes the Bong to the C-Lister. The C-Lister begins to point at the words "Bhang Tour" on the whiteboard.

THE C-LISTER
(while smoking)
Few things: First. Looks like
you've got a typo in your title
there. Pretty sure it should say
"Bong Tour". B-O-N-G.

VISHAL
(annoyed)
Bhang. B-H-A-N-G. It's a weed drink
from India. A Bong is a person from
Bangladesh.

THE C-LISTER
(seemingly oblivious to
Vishal's response)

Second, really really wish you'd
worn a mo-cap suit for at least
some of the pitch. Don't want to
call you guys amateurs, but your
little horse and pony show wasn't
doing it for me without it.

VISHAL
We didn't really have much
notice...

THE C-LISTER

And third, not a huge thing,
really, really not a big deal at
all, but, well, I don't exactly
understand the... what were those
creatures you were on your knees
for, midgets, or jockeys?

DREW

(excited)
Hobbits!

VISHAL

(corrective)
Little people!

THE C-LISTER frowns a bit upon hearing the response.

DREW (CONT'D)

Wait... do you not like them?

THE C-LISTER

It's not that I don't like them,
per se... I'm just not sure people
are gonna get it. I mean... how
many people want to watch a movie
where a midget dies?

VISHAL

(firm)
He has to!

DREW

(excited)
We are totally open to
rewriting the ending.

VISHAL shares a glance of strong reproach with Drew, which
Drew ignores.

THE C-LISTER

(suddenly very foreboding,
with wisdom and fear)
The Lollipop Guild runs this
fucking town, you know?

DREW

Wizard of Oz?

THE C-LISTER

Bingo. Fun fact --- that movie is
all based on true events. Writer
was a savant.

DREW

Amazing. I knew it!

VISHAL

I haven't heard that before...

THE C-LISTER

That's why I'm here, boys! You guys are totally naive to what is going on out here. You can't have little people just fighting each other. They have a union.

DREW

What? *Lord of the Rings* had no problem having fights with little people involved.

THE C-LISTER

Those hobbits were CGI. Just trust me, you don't want to get on these guys' bad side. Rule of thumb -- a little person is a big liability.

VISHAL

Um, those hobbits were not CGI.

THE C-LISTER

Of course they were. You think Elijah Wood just got on his knees like you guys?

Vishal raises a hand to dispute the point more, but is interrupted by a hopeful Drew.

DREW

What about jockeys, instead? I have that scene about the horse.

VISHAL

It's just...

THE C-LISTER

(forcefully)

Listen, man! Do you want to survive in this industry? Make taller enemies if you know what is good for you. The little ones run in packs. They've got a whole "Fellowship" sort of thing going on.

DREW

(with awe)

Woah... JUST like *Lord of the Rings*...

VISHAL

I don't know man... this movie is sort of based on true events.

THE C-LISTER

You know what's crazy? Tolkien said the same thing to me once. I'm a bit of a method-writer myself... still working at it. How do you think I know not to cross these little fuckers?

VISHAL

Oh. Well...

THE C-LISTER

Yeah. Here, just... let me guide you guys and we'll save a whole lot of Middle Earth and whatnot. You make that correction and the script is a hit.

DREW

Really?!

VISHAL

Yeah!?

THE C-LISTER

I know so! Listen, some of my friends will be down at *The Comedy Store* later this evening. Why don't you come pitch it to them? Under my supervision, of course.

The C-Lister suddenly gets a call on his phone. The ring-tone is Randy Newman's *Short People*. We briefly see the call is from the contact "UPPER MANAGEMENT"

THE C-LISTER (CONT'D)

Hey, one second. I have to take this.

The C-Lister removes himself from Vishal and Drew's immediate vicinity and begins whispering into his phone somewhat secretively. Vishal and Drew begin bickering.

VISHAL

We are not changing the ending, Drew.

DREW

Be reasonable man. This could be our chance!

VISHAL

Dude, I'm not going to sacrifice my artistic integrity. Half of what he is saying sounds just wrong and made-up to me.

DREW

I know, you want to sacrifice a little person. Which, listen... all movies are made-up and most of them get it wrong. So maybe we should drop the killing the little person thing?

VISHAL

Hey! It's not some gimmick man, the plot just wouldn't make sense any other way!

The C-Lister hangs up the phone and walks back over to Drew and Vishal.

THE C-LISTER

Hey guys, I'm sorry I gotta jet so quick, but I was serious, you guys should come down to The *Comedy Store* later tonight. Let's make your dreams come true.

DREW

(high-fiving The C-Lister)
For sure, man! For sure!

VISHAL

(unhappy)
Yeah... we'll see.

THE C-LISTER

(ignoring Vishal's
hesitance and pouncing
upon Drew's enthusiasm)
Oh, and if you don't mind --- we used to have this great bong down there, but... well, let's just say, it was left entrusted to some very unfunny hands and met an ending not unlike your script's little guy.
(solemnly, performing a
hail mary)
may he rest in peace.

THE C-LISTER (CONT'D)

Would you guys mind bringing yours?

DREW

We'd be glad to!

VISHAL

(adamant)
No, no, no! No way!

THE C-LISTER

Oh... well, maybe I won't help you after all. Seems a simple enough request considering you're going to be legends when it's all over.

DREW

(to Vishal, with anger)
Come on, man! We've been working on this script for over a year.

VISHAL

I'll have to think about it. You remember what *Rahul* said about the Bong...

DREW

Don't worry, brotha! We'll be there.

THE C-LISTER

(only acknowledging Drew)
Poifect. I'll show myself out.

The C-Lister begins walking toward the staircase before looking over his shoulder and calling out:

THE C-LISTER (CONT'D)

Oh, and bring some weed! My friends are fiends.

VISHAL

We... I mean, you, have already smoked like half of what we ordered!

DREW

Shhhh! Of course, man! We'll bring it all.

THE C-LISTER

Just think of it as a mini Bong Tour, ya know? Anyway, cya there... let's say, 4:20, sharp?

THE C-Lister makes his exit in an obnoxious fashion, accidentally bumping into and knocking down some random items as he stumbles up the stairs in a stoned stupor.

INT. BASEMENT - CONTINUOUS

DREW

Dude, can you believe our luck? Now just to make those corrections he asked for.

Drew is seen replacing the crudely drawn little people on the whiteboard with jockeys. They are essentially the same, but are all riding horses.

DREW (CONT'D)

Vishal? I need your input man...

We pan over to Vishal, who is staring vacantly at The Bong. We join Vishal for a moment in his point of view. He stares at Drew's animated movements, but we hear Drew's audio coming out fuzzy and muffled. Vishal seems worried, lost in thought. He reaches toward The Bong and takes a massive rip.

EXT. THE COMEDY STORE - LATER THAT DAY

It's peak golden hour as Drew and Vishal walk toward the doors of *The Comedy Store*. A person is seen removing and adhering various letters to the marquee. The C-Lister is bouncing around near the entrance. His eyes light up when he sees Drew and Vishal. Vishal is wearing the motion-capture suit, which is dirtied and covered in a bit of dry blood.

THE C-LISTER

Fellas! You made it, and perfect timing too.

DREW

Something about to start?

THE C-LISTER

No. No no... I'm just criminally sober right now. I feel like Gollum chasing the ring, ya know?

THE C-LISTER (CONT'D)

(looking at Vishal's
costuming)

Oh good! You found the suit! What about the...

Vishal discretely opens his backpack and shows The C-Lister the Bong, the sight of which makes The C-Lister smile.

THE C-LISTER (CONT'D)

Oh fellas, fellas, you pulled through! Beautiful. Hey, Vishal ---

VISHAL

Yeah?

THE C-LISTER

What did the stoned alpaca say to the other stoned alpaca?

VISHAL

Huh?

THE C-LISTER

Alpaca Bowl!

The C-Lister proceeds to imitate what might be the mating call of an Alpaca as he enters The Comedy Store. Vishal gives Drew a look of displeasure, but Drew finds it funny and shrugs his shoulders.

VISHAL

(hesitating before
following The C-Lister)

I'm not sure I want to be
affiliated with this guy if that's
his idea of comedy.

DREW

(still chuckling)

Get off your high horse man, it's
just some family-friendly barn-yard
humor. Middle America loves that
kind of shit. Just... trust me. The
C-Lister knows his shit, man. This
isn't his first rodeo, and I have a
feeling it won't be his last.

INT. COMEDY STORE.

The C-Lister guides Vishal and Drew into a VIP backroom and sits them down. The Bong makes its way around as the trio exchange pleasantries. Just then, AN A-LISTER walks in. His eyes appear bloodshot to hell and is dressed in shamanic garb.

He appears to be tweaking on something and doesn't appear to be aware of the existence of Vishal and Drew whatsoever. He is locked in 100% on the C-Lister.

THE A-LISTER

I am so sorry I'm late.

THE C-LISTER

You're actually a few hours early!

THE A-LISTER

Is that right? I'll level with you.
I have zero concept of time right
now. Ha! Fuckin' shamanism!

The C-Lister gives the A-Lister a look up and down. Reality shimmers and the scene takes on a sudden red-light feel.

THE C-LISTER

You are a shaman these days, aren't you?

THE A-LISTER

You have no idea. No idea.

VISHAL (ASIDE)

(whispered to Drew)

Woah. Vibe shift.

DREW

(back toward Vishal)

Weird, right? Seems like things instantly got more of a bad-ass, red light feel as soon as he came in.

VISHAL

Damn... I guess I really didn't know what to expect.

THE A-LISTER

(to the room at large)

I'm superrrrrrr lost right now. Are there people talking about me right now? I swear I can sense people talking about me.

THE C-LISTER

I think my friends over there were just psychoanalyzing you a bit.

THE A-LISTER

Oh is that what that was? Not again...

The A-Lister suddenly seems pissed off and paranoid, but can't seem to spot where Vishal and Drew are standing in relation to his field of vision.

THE A-LISTER (CONT'D)

(after taking a deep breath)

Yeah. I can still feel it happening. Don't like it.

THE C-LISTER

No one does. We've been over this before. But you can handle it, you don't crack! That's why you're famous, and they're not.

THE A-LISTER
(self-satisfied)
I am famous, aren't I?

THE C-LISTER
Mmm. Indeed. Very. And with your
help, I'll soon be famous again
too! Look over here, my man.

The C-Lister physically turns the A-Lister around, who seems to be unable to do so himself. The A-Lister looks Drew and Vishal up and down a few times over.

THE A-LISTER
(to Vishal)
Hey, nice mo-cap suit! Dress to
impress, huh? I wish I would have
known, I'd have brought mine too.
What brand is that? The G5? Those
are pretty cute. I rock a Teslasuit
myself.

THE C-LISTER
(gesturing excitedly toward
Vishal and Drew)
Ahem! These were those writers I
was telling you about! Man, have
these two got one helluva
screenplay.

THE A-LISTER
(intrigued)
Oh, is that so?

The A-Lister's eyes depart from the duo and he sees the bong. We linger for a moment as hints of celestial Indian music can be heard distantly.

The C-Lister grabs Drew and Vishal by the shoulder and pulls them into a huddle.

THE C-LISTER (ASIDE)
This is it, boys. You ready for
your pitch?

VISHAL
Uhhh... Not really...

THE C-LISTER
Of course you are, my guys! Go get
it!

The C-Lister un-huddles and gives Drew and Vishal a loud slap and push forward on the back.

DREW
(summoning courage)
Well, I guess we should, uh... give
you the pitch.

VISHAL
(nervously)
Yes, so it starts in a-

The A-Lister lifts up a finger to pause.

THE A-LISTER
No, no, no. Not liking the
direction this is going already.
Listen, I can tell you guys are new
to this, so I'm just gonna drive,
okay?

The A-Lister pulls out a disgusting and sullied bag filled
with what looks like slimy brown sugar. It's DMT. The A-
Lister grabs the bong and loads a very large amount into the
bowl.

THE A-LISTER (CONT'D)
You guys ever smoked DMT before?
Cuts right past the bullshit. Just
ungirdled, raw, reality.

The A-Lister looks to be having a spiritual moment with
himself. He takes a deep breath before sliding the bong
toward the group.

THE A-LISTER (CONT'D)
(like a boss)
Rip this... and then, only then,
pitch it to me.

Vishal and Drew are hesitant. Upon seeing their reluctance,
The C-Lister takes the initiative.

THE C-LISTER
You snooze ya lose. See ya on the
other side fellas!

The C-Lister grabs the bong and takes a rip. Drew and Vishal,
upon seeing the C-Lister full send it, are filled with
determination. They each take a huge rip as well. The A-
Lister grabs the bong like a fiend, adds twice the original
amount on top of the bowl, and snaps it.

VISHAL
(exhaling)
So, it starts in...

The A-Lister holds his finger up again.

THE A-LISTER
(with DMT smoke still in
his lungs)
No words. Just eyes.

As the A-Lister finishes speaking, time slows. Blast off. We see close ups of each character's eyes. At first it seems as if nothing is happening but soon we see scenes from the movie reflected in their eyes in hyper speed. Everyone's expressions change as we pan through the circle. We see moments of joy, hilarity, and heartbreak. The C-Lister's expression seems terrified.

Ultimately, as the reflections of the movie wrap up we settle on the A-Lister's face as tears form and begin streaming down his face. Time resumes normal speed as the DMT wears off.

THE A-LISTER (CONT'D)
Oh my God. It's beautiful...
The midget, does he have to die?

	VISHAL	DREW
(sadly)		(excitedly)
Yes		Yes

The two look at each other confused for a moment as the A-Lister ponders briefly.

THE A-LISTER
I mean it's got everything. The
tide of emotions. Comedy,
adventure, betrayal, symbolism. And
the third act, that's some
Gladiator, *Princess Bride* sort of
shit... but on a literally and
figuratively smaller level.
Fellas... we've GOT to make this
movie.

	DREW	VISHAL
Are you serious?!		What?!

THE A-LISTER
Super, dead serious.

VISHAL
But, what about the strike?

THE A-LISTER
Let me take care of that. Oh... and
from now on guys: stay in
character.

The A-Lister abruptly stands up, whipping his phone out of his pocket and seeming to make multiple calls simultaneously.

VISHAL
(quizzically)
What did he mean by 'stay in character?'

Drew shrugs and looks confusedly back at Vishal.

THE A-LISTER
(speaking into his phone to
an UPPER MANAGEMENT
contact)
Yes, put me through to your jockey
friend at Santa Anita. I'm going to
need a horse. Maybe a few.

UPPER MANAGEMENT CONTACT
(inaudible, v.o.)

THE A-LISTER
(threateningly)
Yeah? Well have him talk to the
higher-ups then, and get
permission.

The A-Lister makes motions toward the C-Lister to leave. He exits without saying goodbye.

EXT. THE COMEDY STORE - SUNSET

The mood nearly evokes Noir. Drew and Vishal can barely contain their excitement. The C-Lister motions them to hang back as he runs to catch up to the A-Lister.

THE C-LISTER
(unusually formal)
Hey, sorry to interrupt the calls.
It's just... Do you think this
movie could be my chance? To you
know... Get back on the B-list?

The A-Lister hangs up the phone.

THE A-LISTER
I'll have to ask Upper Management,
but... yeah, there's a... chance. A
SOLID chance. Hell, with this
script? You may even have another
day in the sun as an A-Lister. An
artistic renaissance!

The A-Lister throws an arm around the C-Lister's shoulder slapping it reassuringly twice. A black car pulls up and The A-Lister promptly gets in. The C-Lister makes his way back to Drew and Vishal, satisfaction stretched across his face.

INT. THE COMEDY STORE - CONTINUOUS

THE C-LISTER

We're making the movie! Well boys, you're minor celebrities now. That means, tonight? The weed and the strange are on me. Just remember how you got here, fellas.

For a moment The C-Lister takes on a threatening aspect.

THE C-LISTER (CONT'D)

I'll say this only once though.
Don't betray me, you hear me? Don't cross me, and we'll be just fine.
We'll be just fine.

Drew and Vishal are taken aback for a moment, exchanging a look as if to say it's time to leave.

THE C-LISTER (CONT'D)

(changing tone just in time
to allay the most serious
fears his reaction was
causing)

I'm just fucking with you guys,
Jesus! It's called being funny.
C'mon! Let me show you something.

The C-Lister skips along happily, not unlike Gollum, and leads them beyond the VIP room to a darkened hallway.

Celestial Indian music plays. The Shrine has clippings from newspapers about certain actors' success, locations on a map are circled ala *Beautiful Mind*. An image of Vishnu frames it all. It is constructed primarily out of Solo Cups, an empty pedestal at its center.

THE C-LISTER (CONT'D)

What do you think?

DREW

Is this a... is this some sort of shrine?

THE C-LISTER

Yes! Yes! It's a shrine for the Bong that got us here!

While Drew stares at the Bong Shrine, Vishal notices another, stranger shrine adjacent. It appears to be a "Hate Shrine", dedicated toward THE COMEDIAN.

Suddenly, the C-Lister is standing directly behind Vishal, giving him a shoulder massage.

THE C-LISTER (CONT'D)

You like this one, hm? Yes... This piece evokes the right... feeling, I think.

The Getty asked me for it, but it really is priceless to me.

Grabbing his grinder and Vishal's weed (which Vishal just now starts to notice is missing from his possession) from the Hate Shrine --- specifically the place where The Comedian's genitalia should be, the C-Lister walks across the room and places the Bong atop the shrine. As he begins to load it, Vishal grabs Drew by the arm.

VISHAL (ASIDE)

(quiet & nervous, to Drew)
Dude, he's giving me the creeps.

DREW

(whispering)
What do you mean, dude? Just look at what is happening, right now! I think we really might be making this movie, man.

VISHAL

You think so?

DREW

Yeah, and this fucker brought us here, so just... Suck it up. He's just a little eccentric.

THE C-LISTER

(suddenly right up close behind the writers)
You guys ready for this?

The C-Lister presents the freshly loaded bong.

The C-Lister performs a quick and bizarre ceremony that only he himself could be said to fully understand, and having established the blessing somehow sufficient in stature for whatever sort of spiritual peace he was trying to achieve with the shrine in the first place, proceeds to light up yet another huge bowl from the bong.

Vishal, witnessing The C-Lister's unabashed depravity, can be seen plainly wondering if his future holds that for him as well and goes down an existential train of thought.

The bong again seems to again take on a weight a bit out of the ordinary as it is passed in their circle. There is definitely still some residual DMT in the basin as Drew and Vishal take their hits.

THE C-LISTER (CONT'D)

(scoffs)

Oooo man. You guys feeling this?
Crazy stuff man. You're going to
need to be pretty loaded for some
of the acts tonight. Trust me.

Smoke fills the room as a montage of the evening begins.

MONTAGE - VARIOUS

Music begins [Hobo Johnson, What's The AQI Of This Bong Rip]

A) INT. THE COMEDY STORE - SUNSET - We see the C-Lister dump the bong water into a trash can, which causes the contents of the trash can to start on fire. A club-wide panic briefly occurs and champagne is taken from behind the bar and used in an attempt to extinguish the chemical fire. Crew members are running toward the trash-can fire and getting injured in their attempts at doing so. It's a multi-person effort and it's not going particularly well, but that isn't stopping the C-Lister and the writers from occasionally exercising all muscles of hubris as they take massive pulls off of their champagne bottles like there is no tomorrow.

In the heat of the battle with the chemical fire, the reflection of the bubbles against the C-Lister's mouth make him briefly appear rabid.

B) INT. THE COMEDY STORE - SUNSET - In the aftermath of the fire, we see the C-Lister pour the remaining champagne into the bong. A few crew members are covered in burns and over-the-top bandages, but are generally still hanging out, enjoying the party.

Everyone is taking rips off the champagne bong, and getting utterly blitzed.

C) INT. THE COMEDY STORE - SUNSET - We see a council of Elrond-esque gathering around the bong. A little person struts in with a bag of Hashish and exclaims:

LITTLE PERSON / DWARF

And my hash!

D) EXT. THE COMEDY STORE - EVENING - The Marquee work has been finished and we can see that The Comedian is headlining.

E) INT. THE COMEDY STORE - EVENING - We see The Comedian on stage doing standup and killing it. The C-Lister grimaces every time the audience laughs.

F) INT. THE COMEDY STORE - NIGHT - We see everyone having a party back in the VIP lounge after the show. The Comedian attempts to smoke from the bong but is interrupted by a violent, Bilbo-Baggins-esque eruption from the C-Lister. Someone says they're headed to a mansion party and invites everyone.

G) INT. LIMOSUINE - NIGHT - Everyone is in a limousine taking massive rips off the bong. We see a few famous people randomly appearing in the limo until it's full. People keep shifting in and out of the seats next to Drew & Vishal ala *Garden State*. One group of passengers that cross paths with them are little people.

The C-Lister is seen making out with one of the little people in the limo. Is this little person female? Perhaps. But it is a coin-flip. Could just as easily be a wig. The C-Lister is seen winking and raising a finger to his lips as he connects with Vishal & Drew's eyes.

H) EXT. A HOLLYWOOD MANSION - NIGHT - We see a Hollywood Comedy Icon welcoming everyone into the mansion.

I) EXT. A HOLLYWOOD MANSION - NIGHT The party is in full swing and joyous. We see copious drug use. The party continues outside near a pool, from a birds-eye view of the party, we see what appears to be a live-action horse ridden by a jockey intermingling with partygoers. The Jockey is drinking, and he is also giving the horse booze.

ABRUPT END OF MONTAGE

EXT. HOLLYWOOD MANSION - MORNING

The sun rises over the Hollywood Hills. The aftermath of last night's party is biblical-bodies are strewn across lounge chairs, a little person is passed out inside an empty ice sculpture, and a horse (somehow in sunglasses) is still lazily drinking from the infinity pool.

Vishal is asleep on a deck chair, still wearing the mo-cap suit, but now also inexplicably wrapped in a fur coat. He stirs awake, groggy.

Drew is face down in a koi pond, lightly snoring. The fish are aggressively avoiding him.

The C-Lister is nowhere to be found.

A phone buzzes violently in Vishal's pocket. His bloodshot eyes crack open. He fumbles for his phone. Dozens of notifications flood the screen.

INSERT PHONE SCREEN - TMZ NOTIFICATION BARRAGE

TMZ: A-Lister Launches New Movie With Mystery Writers—Who Are They?

Page Six: Exclusive: Secret Comedy Store Casting Call Happening Now!

Just Jared: Spotted! A-Lister & C-Lister Partying With Jockeys & A Horse?

Perez Hilton: WTF is a 'Bong Tour' and Why Is Hollywood Losing Its Mind Over It?

Yahoo! News: Photo Exclusive - Drunk Motion-Capture Guy Stumbles Into Limo With Champagne Bong

(Attached image: Vishal, still in the mo-cap suit, mid-stumble, with Drew clinging to the bong like it's the Ark of the Covenant. In the background, the C-Lister appears to be making out with someone of ambiguous height & gender.)

Vishal blinks at the screen, trying to process. He nudges Drew, who blubbers awake, coughing up koi pond water.

EXT. SOMEWHERE ELSE - THAT MORNING

Willie sits in a coffee shop, sipping tea and scrolling her phone. As soon as she sees the TMZ headline, she chokes on her drink.

Her eyes widen at the incriminating images.

WILLIE
(quietly, to herself)
Oh my god.

She frantically types a text.

INSERT PHONE SCREEN - WILLIE'S TEXTS

9:01 AM
WILLIE: PLEASE tell me you did NOT
just make TMZ.

9:02 AM

WILLIE: And why are you still
wearing the mo-cap suit??? You look
like hell.

9:04 AM

WILLIE: I assume you also don't
know that they're literally holding
CASTING CALLS for your movie RIGHT
NOW??

9:06 AM

WILLIE: Get. Up. Get. To. The.
Comedy. Store. NOW.

INSERT PHONE SCREEN - VISHAL'S TEXTS

9:10 AM

VISHAL: Alive.

9:10 AM (CONT'D)

VISHAL: En route.

Vishal rips off the fur coat and drags Drew toward the limo -
still inexplicably waiting outside.

—

ACT 2

INT. THE COMEDY STORE - MORNING

Vishal and Drew stumble into the casting call, still loosely smelling of champagne bong smoke. Before they can process what is happening, the A-Lister's booming voice calls from inside.

THE A-LISTER

And next up, for the role of Dhruv
aka Samwise.

The C-Lister is beaming at the A-Lister, who suddenly seems to be struggling a bit.

THE A-LISTER (CONT'D)

You, uh...
what's your name again?
...Shit.

THE A-LISTER (CONT'D)

(claps once)
Action.

Cameras begin rolling on the audition video.

On his knees to imitate the proper height of his character, the C-Lister is giving it his all, his absolute magnum opus of a performance with an either poorly researched, or a poorly delivered Indian accent (likely both) --- and it's bad. Really, really bad.

THE C-LISTER

I wonder if people will ever say,

"let's hear about Vidu and the
Bhang"

and they'll say:

"Yes, it's one of my favorite
stories. Vidu was really
courageous, wasn't he, Dad?"

"Yes, my boy. The most famousest of
Bongs and that's saying a lot'.

One crew-member begins to reluctantly clap. Nobody else joins him and the other crew-members look at him in reproach. The camera operator makes a move to stop recording, but The C-Lister abruptly starts again.

THE C-LISTER (CONT'D)
 (with awkward phrasing)
 I think, Mr. Vidu, I do understand.
 I know now.

Folk in those stories had lots of
 chances of turning back only they
 didn't. Because they were holding
 on to something.

The camera operator again moves to stop recording.

THE C-LISTER (CONT'D)
*(clears throat, switching to a
 proud, over-enunciated tone)*
 "Naag log toh... ghoomne mein hi... kho
 jaate hain!"

Silence. A beat. The translator on set blinks.
 The one Indian crew member — a PA near craft services —
 slowly looks up, horrified.

INDIAN PA
 (quietly, to no one)
 Did he just say... snake people get
 lost when they walk?

The C-Lister throws his arms wide, grinning like he just
 nailed Shakespeare.

THE C-LISTER
 Boom. Nailed it. That's your tag
 line, right there!

The camera operator doesn't stop recording.
 No one moves. The Indian PA just walks off set, muttering in
 disbelief.

Various camera crew look to the A-Lister for direction as the
 onlookers are unsure whether or not the C-Lister has
 finished.

THE A-LISTER
 And... Cut. Thanks, uh... Thanks,
 for that... that was, uh, great.

The C-Lister eagerly descends from the stage and approaches
 the A-Lister. The A-Lister shakes his hand and paternally
 taps him on the shoulder.

THE C-LISTER
 (sincerely)
 Did I do okay?
 (MORE)

THE C-LISTER (CONT'D)

I was so nervous up there.
Competition looks pretty stiff.

The C-Lister eyes the little people with obvious insecurity, but the A-Lister wraps his arm around him, patting him assuredly.

THE A-LISTER

Oh yeah. Phenomenal. The role is basically in the bag. I've got my Samwise right here, indeed-y, I've got him righhhhhht here.

Subtle celestial Indian music plays, as amongst a crew of hopeful little people (think Lollipop gang), we see the soon-to-be star HOLLYWOOD LITTLE PERSON get on stage.

HOLLYWOOD LITTLE PERSON

(emotive, moving)

What makes a man big? What makes a man small? Is it not the content of his heart, that marks him in his truest form?

His courage in the shadow of oppression, his valor in the pursuit of the lofty. His composure, not when he is sky high, but when he is at rock bottom.

For those who doubt the power of the bhang, I say, let them come! This is one dwarf they will not ensnare easily. For though our people are small, our constitution is beyond any mere mortal's reach.

I will take the bhang, though I do not know the way.

The Hollywood Little Person pauses for a moment, mirroring Rodin's *The Thinker*, before consuming the Bhang Lassi in front of him. Set workers begin clapping, slowly at first, and then loudly in unison.

THE A-LISTER

(stunned)

This is it. I can see why we need the midget now. Yes. This is gonna work.

The A-Lister clasps his hands to his face, tears welling in his eyes. Looking over at the boys, who are also crying, the A-Lister struggles to regain his composure.

THE A-LISTER (CONT'D)
 Fellas, you got yourselves a
 blockbuster here. I'm sure of it.
 Dare I say...

The A-Lister produces a handkerchief and dabs his face.

THE A-LISTER (CONT'D)
 a classic?

INT. COMEDY STORE - AFTERNOON

A day later, casting call results are being posted. We see the C-Lister scan the list with increasing disappointment. He spots his name and slowly traces his finger across the paper. He has been cast as "Motion Capture Actor #2 aka Gollum". One line above, we see the role of "Motion Capture Actor #1 aka Shadowfax" has been given to the Comedian's German Shepherd.

The C-Lister traces his finger up the role list to find the role he auditioned for - "Dhruv aka Samwise". As he traces his finger to the opposite side of the paper, he begins losing his shit as he sees that The Comedian has been cast in his place. One line above, we see "Vidu aka Frodo" has been cast, as expected, to the Hollywood Little Person, who is seen receiving congratulations from various crew members.

The C-Lister calls up the A-Lister to complain.

THE C-LISTER
 Where the hell are you at, man?
 Have you seen the casting results?
 This is some fucking bullshit. You
 told me I had the role in the bag!

THE A-LISTER (V.O.)
 Listen, I know you're angry. But
 the writers and I talked about it
 with casting, and a comedian
 honestly just fits the height
 profile better. It's really nothing
 personal. Besides, think about his
 comedy. Samwise isn't supposed to
 be funny. Our "comedian" is perfect
 for the role.

THE C-LISTER
 (interrupting)
 But... but...

THE A-LISTER
 (interrupting)
 Listen! I'm doing you a favor here.
 (MORE)

THE A-LISTER (CONT'D)
 Now, do you want to be a part of
 filmmaking history, or not? If not,
 it's easy to insert things using
 CGI these days. The choice is
 yours.

The C-Lister is in shock and his face tinges red with pain as
 the A-Lister cuts the call.

THE A-LISTER (CONT'D)
 Now, where were we? Oh, that's
 right: I'm changing the world.

MONTAGE - VARIOUS

We see the filmmaking process of scenes from *Bong Tour*
 through the eyes of the filmmakers.

A) The hair and makeup is very reminiscent of *The Lord of the
 Rings*. Throughout the montage, we hear various interjections
 from The A-Lister:

THE A-LISTER
 Is anybody else catching that
 Tolkien vibe?

RANDOM PRODUCTION ASSISTANT
 Yeah, like *Lord of the Rings*!

THE A-LISTER
 What? Huh? No. The *Silmarillion*.
 Jesus Christ, are you new or
 something?

The A-Lister begins getting visibly perturbed.

THE A-LISTER (CONT'D)
 You know what? Get off my fucking
 set!

B) We see the writing room, with extremely detailed vision
 boards and story boarding.

THE A-LISTER (CONT'D)
 (enamoring the high-quality
 visualizations)

I gotta say fellas, I usually hate
 them... but, I'm really feeling a
 trilogy on this one.

C) The A-Lister measuring the height of each little person, making notes, looking stunned at his observations, causing him to double-check his math in his notebook, which we see involves trigonometry and advanced calculus.

THE A-LISTER (CONT'D)
This is gonna be the best feature
length film since *Willow*, mark my
fucking words.

D) With a clearly Emotionally Moved Editor, both in disbelief watching some of the footage.

THE A-LISTER (CONT'D)
Effortless. Have you ever seen so
many perfect one takes?

THE A-LISTER (CONT'D)
(pausing, then stamping his
foot excitedly with a
smile)
Yes... Yes. This is going to make
the world a better place.

E) The A-Lister splashing water on his face and pep-talking himself in the mirror of a bathroom.

THE A-LISTER (CONT'D)
Peter Jackson has nothing on you,
motherfucker!

F) In a scene with a heavy score of little people already involved, the A-Lister looks discontented. Vishal and Drew are watching the action from behind the director's chair.

THE A-LISTER (CONT'D)
(pausing and running his
fingers beneath his chin
after the action is cut)
I think we need more midgets.

He checks his watch.

THE A-LISTER (CONT'D)
I don't have time to call the
agency. We only have these horses
until four.

The A-Lister is seen surveying the horses on set, which are in a make-shift pen eating hay. He suddenly spots a HORSE JOCKEY (not an actual little person).

THE A-LISTER (CONT'D)
 (pointing, and then
 approaching the jockey)
 Hey! You'll do. Yeah, you, little
 man.

HORSE JOCKEY
 (pointing at himself)
 Me?

THE A-LISTER
 Yeah! Come on over here. Make
 yourself at home.

The jockey joins the little people, inducing severe glares
 from them.

HORSE JOCKEY
 (uncomfortably)
 What am I doing again?

THE A-LISTER
 (confidently)
 Just act natural.

As filming gets set to begin, the Comedian's GERMAN SHEPHERD
 (in a Motion Capture Suit) who has been priorly lying down on
 set, becomes alert and begins barking at the jockey
 repeatedly.

THE A-LISTER (CONT'D)
 Man, he does not like you, huh?

THE A-LISTER (CONT'D)
 (to the little people, who
 are all laughing and
 pointing at the jockey
 disparagingly)
 Kind of like *Terminator*, heh.

VISHAL
 (to the A-Lister, upset)
 Have you even been watching that
 list of movies I sent you? This is
 way more like *Bhoot Unkle*. You need
 to study this stuff or it's not
 going to pass as authentic. Have
 some artistic integrity, man.

G) The A-Lister back at the editing station with the
 Emotionally Moved Editor, looking at some very bizarre
 footage of horses of different colors.

THE A-LISTER
 (with loving curiosity at
 his own creation)
 This part with the horses.
 Resembles *Wizard of Oz*, a bit,
 doesn't it?

EMOTIONALLY MOVED EDITOR
 Almost uncanny.

THE A-LISTER
 (like a proud father)
 No munchkin suicides or gropings on
 this set though!

The emotionally moved editor nods supportively as the A-
 Lister puts one hand on his shoulder paternally.

THE A-LISTER (CONT'D)
 (with a tear in his eye)
 Man, it's been a steep, steep
 climb, but we're gonna make it.

THE A-LISTER (CONT'D)
 (Breaking down a bit)
 We're gonna make it.

H) The A-Lister breaking down and studying film footage of
 Bollywood & Bengali movies featuring little people with
 Vishal mentoring him. A scene from *Aunty No. 1* is shown where
 a little person is tickled. The A-Lister slows down the scene
 to ultra slo-mo takes some notes.

VISHAL
 You like him, no? That's Lilliput.
 He's an icon.

The A-Lister looks back at the screen in disbelief, and
 continues taking more notes, underlining Lilliput.

J) The A-Lister, in the same bathroom as earlier is taking a
 shit while negotiating on a tense phone call.

THE A-LISTER
 You're out of you mind if you think
 we're going with *Industrial Light &
 Magic*, Whore-Hay. There are way too
 many eyes on this.

GEORGE LUCAS
 (inaudible)

THE A-LISTER
 Look, you may think I'm just
 laundering money down here, but I'm
 still squeezing out artistic
 integrity, every fucking day.

GEORGE LUCAS
 (inaudible)

THE A-LISTER
 (defensively)
 Uh-huh? Is that right?

GEORGE LUCAS
 (inaudible)

THE A-LISTER
 (angry)
 You of all people should know you
 can't put a price on inspiration.

The A-Lister hangs up the phone and slams the bathroom stall door with his fists in frustration.

THE A-LISTER (CONT'D)
 (pep-talking himself)
 Go out there and prove it.

THE MONTAGE ENDS AS WE JOIN THE FILMING OF WHAT SEEMS TO
 BE A MUCH DARKER SCENE THAN WHAT YOU WOULD EXPECT FROM A
 COMEDY

EXT. ON A FILM SET THAT LOOKS LIKE LORD OF THE RINGS - NOON

The C-Lister, in a full motion-capture suit, is being abused mercilessly on set by the Comedian, portraying Dhruv aka Samwise.

The A-Lister loves the direction, but doesn't find it believable enough.

THE A-LISTER
 CUT! Hey... uhhh, Samwise? Are you
 able to be meaner to... Mo-Cap
 Actor Number 2 here, if possible? I
 mean... Listen, this midget...

The A-Lister points at the Hollywood Little Person.

THE A-LISTER (CONT'D)
 Just look at our beautiful little
 hero, will ya? C'mon... Amazing.
 Right? Now, Samwise...
 (MORE)

THE A-LISTER (CONT'D)

I mean, Dhruv...

(pointing at Vidu)

Vidu here, he's your Frodo, okay?

The Comedian nods and smiles, a sudden & sentimental tear trickling down his face.

THE A-LISTER (CONT'D)

You guys have come a long way with the Bhang, and if you don't get this Bhang to the Ganges... Your friend, here? The fate of the world? Well, it will be sealed. They will find the bhang, and they will kill the one who carries it. And, all the suffering? All the loss? It was for nothing. You remember Baba Gandalfi's sacrifice... Act 1, right?

The Comedian seems to be having a bit of a hard time recollecting Baba Gandalfi's sacrifice, which seems a bit strange, considering it seemed to carry an obvious and great significance to everybody else on set as all other set-members are having an emotional reaction at the mere mention of the name.

THE A-LISTER (CONT'D)

(to the comedian, blank, confused looking)

Do you want Baba Gandalfi to have died for nothing?

THE COMEDIAN

Well, is it up to me?

THE A-LISTER

Well, sort of. If you think about it... I mean, just take a look over there at, this, this thing.. this Gollum.

The A-Lister points at the C-Lister, who proceeds to point confusedly back at himself while mouthing "Me?" to the A-Lister, which strikes an instinct within the A-Lister to want to further confirm by pointing back at the C-Lister, mouthing, "Yes, You!"

The A-Lister and the C-Lister both visibly trip out on the loop for a brief moment before continuing on. Reality seems to slightly shimmer.

THE A-LISTER (CONT'D)

(with disgust)

Just look at him, he is beyond redemption. Nothing more than a freak-show, has-been, forged out of corruption and vile. And he wants to take your Frodo away from you.

THE COMEDIAN

Never!!! He can't!

THE A-LISTER

Make me believe it, Samwise...
shit... Dhruv. I need to believe
it.

The Comedian seems to take the words to heart and his enthusiasm in response to the A-Lister's prodding makes the A-Lister even more enthused himself. It's a regular Schaudenfreude feedback loop.

THE A-LISTER (CONT'D)

(turning to the crew)

Alright folks, let's give this here humdinger another shot.

THE A-LISTER (CONT'D)

You ready?

The Comedian fashions a leather whip firmly like a leash around the C-Lister's neck.

THE COMEDIAN

(sadistically)

I got this!

THE A-LISTER

And... Action!

When action is called, we see The Comedian give an impassioned performance, with The C-Lister being broken as an individual in his humiliating role. The C-Lister becomes further and further embittered and full of contempt as the scene progresses. We *almost* feel bad for him.

The crew cheers as the action is closed. Lost in the celebration of the Comedian's performance, the C-Lister storms off of the set. Nobody can find him, and nobody really notices, except for Drew and Vishal. They look worriedly and begin pacing after him.

INT. HOLLYWOOD SET

Drew and Vishal can be seen searching for the C-Lister throughout the set at various locations. They meet back up with each other in a hallway.

DREW
Any sign of him?

VISHAL
No. Where could he have gone?

DREW
I don't know man. But I don't think we should risk getting on his bad side, man. He doesn't seem at all okay.

VISHAL
This seems out of my pay grade...
Let's ask... our... "director" what he thinks we should do.

INT. DIRECTOR'S CHAIR AREA - CONTINUOUS

There is a bizarre ayahuasca circle composed of all the important actors for the film - namely, all the little people and the Comedian. Helmed at the center is the A-Lister who has an air of nonchalance about him.

VISHAL
Hey, we need to talk.

DREW
Hey, we need to talk.

THE A-LISTER
(annoyed)
What's going on guys? I'm um...
kind of in the middle of something
really spiritual here.

The A-Lister gestures toward the little people with a nod and a smile.

VISHAL
Yeah, we can't find... shit...
what's his name again?

DREW
(helpfully)
Gollum.

VISHAL

Gollum, that's right. Wait...
Anyway, yeah, we can't find him
anywhere. We're worried that he
cracked, man. Is this going to fuck
up the movie?

THE A-LISTER

Listen, guys... Ease up on the
stressed-ness. Some people just
aren't cut out for the business.
He'll be just fine. He's young.
Still has time to recover.

Drew and Vishal exchange worried glances.

THE A-LISTER (CONT'D)

Listen, fellas... thousands of
well-qualified actors are *literally*
dying to be in this movie, and if
they don't pan out, we always have
comics and jockeys... Man, thank
god the strike is over.

Worst comes to worst, we will use
CGI as a fallback if we have to...
but I promise you, this will not
throw a hitch in production
whatsoever. Okay?

Drew and Vishal look somehow even less at ease. They motion
to speak, but the A-Lister has turned his back on them before
they have an opportunity to do so.

THE A-LISTER (CONT'D)

(dismissively)
Great. Glad we talked... Now, if
there's nothing else, I've got some
filmmaking to take care of over
here.

The A-Lister walks back toward the ayahuasca circle.

Alright, my little elvenfolk, let's
go over the dance choreography one
more time, shall we?

Vishal and Drew try to shake off the absurdity they've just
witnessed. They are still concerned, shaken even, about the
C-Lister.

VISHAL

I'm just worried that... he is going to think we are responsible for this. You heard what he said. He looked scary, man.

DREW

You're right. You know what? Why don't we make a missing person flier?

VISHAL

(with urgency, to Drew)
Good thinking. Why don't we go print them off at Willie's work?

DREW

Genius.

VISHAL

Yeah, that way you can get a discount when you pay.

DREW

When... I pay?

EXT. HOLLYWOOD PRINT SHOP NAMED - "THE PRINT GURU"

Willie, Drew and Vishal are seen walking out of the print shop with tall stacks of flyers. We see Drew immediately staple one of the flyers to the nearest telephone pole. We linger on the shot of the flier. The C-Lister's selfie with the Bong.

They almost immediately receive feedback from the poster, receiving calls from a multitude of celebrities and successful Hollywood Idols, but none of the callers have any information on The C-Lister's whereabouts. They haven't even registered that the flier is for a missing person. They simply state in various forms:

RANDOM FLOATING ICON (V.O.)

That's my Bong. I need my Bong back.

RANDOM FLOATING ICON #2 (V.O.)

All the good movies happened when I had that Bong.

DREW

Dude, people keep saying your cousin's bong is their bong. Like, lots of people.

VISHAL

Must be a popular brand or something.

WILLIE

I don't know... Something is seeming a little... off.

VISHAL

You know what... now that you mention it... I do have some other problems with the direction things are going. I really think we should go back to the ayahuasca circle and bring up our concerns.

WILLIE

Can I come?

DREW

I feel like we need you now more than ever.

WILLIE

Nice to finally be appreciated.

VISHAL

Chalo!

INT. THE COMEDY STORE

Vishal, Drew and Willie walk into the Comedy Store. They approach the A-Lister, who is obviously checking out Willie as she enters, in a more-than-sleazy manner.

THE A-LISTER

Well... who might this lovely lady be?

DREW

Oh, hey, this is Willie. She helped us write the script.

THE A-LISTER

Willie, huh? Wanna make a dick joke... but...

DREW

(grinning like an idiot)
Heh, Dix is actually her last name.

THE A-LISTER

Oh... is that right? That like... a family name? Reflects your heritage... maybe?

Willie is disgusted already. Vishal is becoming agitated and defensive of his friend. As Willie goes to reprimand the A-Lister, she is cut off by Vishal:

VISHAL

(tip-toeing the A-Lister's insensitive statement)

Hey yeah, I've been meaning to speak to you about something.

THE A-LISTER

Hmm?

VISHAL

It's just that I envisioned more of a *Masala Film*, but everybody here is... well, everybody in this movie is white. And I think at least half of this needs to be shot in India.

The A-Lister sighs while nodding. He looks genuinely upset as he puts his arms to his hips.

THE A-LISTER

It's these damn Industry Gods, I tell ya. Look, Vishal, I agree 100%, no... 1,000% percent with you guys, but ultimately this was Upper Management's call, and I can't make that kind of systemic change. I'm powerless. Baby steps, okay?

THE A-LISTER (CONT'D)

(whispering to self)

Not to mention, I can't launder premium US dollars with Indo-American actors.

VISHAL

Wait, what was that?

DREW

The other thing is, um... ahem, per canon, Dhruv should also be a little person, but you've cast a Comedian.

THE A-LISTER

Um, gonna have to respectfully disagree with you there, Drew. I'd say that the Comedian is one of the strongest little people we have on this set.

Look... Guys... I know this is your first movie and a lot is going on, and I'll talk to the powers that be. I promise. But what this film really needs right now, is an ending. Okay? I think you all should head off to India for your brother's wedding.

VISHAL

Cousin's wedding.

THE A-LISTER

Right. Whatever. You head out there, you find out how this whole thing is supposed to go down and you report back, we're on a tight schedule you know?

The A-Lister turns around and from the directors chair pocket, produces as if by providence, three plane tickets. He hands them to Vishal.

THE A-LISTER (CONT'D)

(reassuring)

I was gonna join you... but I think you should take your little girlfriend instead. I'm more of an onshore resource these days.

WILLIE

(laughing the A-Lister's suggestion off, looking shyly at Vishal)

Oh, We're not dating.

By his body language, we can see Vishal's heart sink.

THE A-LISTER

(raising his eyebrows)

Oh, really? Is that right?

The A-Lister sends over a bit of a sleazy smile and Willie instantly regrets announcing her status as a single woman.

VISHAL

Can we please just focus? Are you sure you can do this? I'm worried you're going to need me here for direction.

THE A-LISTER

Um, Vishal? Why the fuck would I need you for direction? I'm the director, remember?

VISHAL

Well, it's just that you've never really done anything in this genre before. Are you sure you won't just totally botch it?

THE A-LISTER

Oh, please! I was born to make this fucking movie. It's in my DNA.

VISHAL

Yeah... that's kind of the colonial attitude that I'm worried about.

THE A-LISTER

Listen. I got this. Okay? What, are you worried some evil fucking corporate guy is going to come mess up your perfect ending? Your ending that you haven't even fucking come up with yet?

VISHAL

Well, um...

THE A-LISTER

Yeah, just think about it, brainiac.

VISHAL

Hm.

THE A-LISTER

So, let's just relax for a second because clearly, none of that is real, ok?

VISHAL

(apologetically)

You're... I guess you're right.

THE A-LISTER

Of course I'm fucking right. Yeah, get a grip on yourself man. You just showed up in this fucking town. Nobody is gonna care if you go missing today or tomorrow. You guys are writers dude, trust me when I say that shooting, production, post-production, the entire thing will go on just fine without you involved whatsoever in the process.

Vishal's face shows an obvious displeasure at what has just been said.

VISHAL

What's the point, then?

THE A-LISTER

What do you mean, what's the point?

VISHAL

I mean, what do you need us for?

THE A-LISTER

Man, you are dumb as nails behind those ears of yours?

Both Vishal and Drew look confused at the A-Lister's sudden shift.

THE A-LISTER (CONT'D)

Have you guys forgotten what this whole thing is about? I need a goddamn ending!

VISHAL

Oh.

DREW

Right!

THE A-LISTER

Just go get us something people can call a climax so we all don't look like fucking idiots for putting our necks on the line back there for you totally unproven amateurs in the first place. Okay?

Vishal and Drew look stunned from the abusive turn the A-Lister has taken. Willie remains shut. After a short pause, the A-Lister perceives he has perhaps overstepped.

THE A-LISTER (CONT'D)

Oh, come on guys. I'm just messing with you. I'd never talk to my dearest friends that way. Come on... Here, Drew, you look tense, buddy, do you wanna hit this?

The A-Lister produces the bong, which he has been carrying around with him in a satchel-type garment worn across his shoulder and chest.

Vishal shoots a quick glance over to Drew, who smiles at seeing a huge bowl of weed loaded on top, and takes a massive hit.

Drew immediately begins coughing.

THE A-LISTER (CONT'D)

(looking a bit
disappointed)

Hold it in, dude!

DREW

What is in that bong, man? That's not normal weed, is it? It tastes like... chemicals, or something.

THE A-LISTER

(smiling)

Right?

DREW

What?!

THE A-LISTER

This film isn't going to direct itself, Drew. We can't put a price on inspiration...

Say, do you have twenty bucks? I bet on the wrong jockey in a fight earlier. I have some big-time people looking to collect on me, and the buck stops with you guys.

The A-Lister eyes Drew up & down before looking nervously at a GANG OF DWARVES who've wandered onto / appeared on set.

THE A-LISTER (CONT'D)

(worriedly)

I... I can't get on their bad side.

Drew stammers.

THE A-LISTER (CONT'D)
 Come on man, I'll get you back, you
 know I'm good for it.

Drew hands the A-Lister his last twenty dollars.

THE A-LISTER (CONT'D)
 (thrilled & relieved)
 Fuck yeah! You are a BIG-time life
 saver.

The A-Lister slaps Drew and Vishal both on their shoulders and offers up a smile vaguely suggesting camaraderie before turning back toward the set. He holds up the \$20 and gives a thumbs up toward the dwarves who seem satisfied at the sight of the bill. As he walks away from the writers, he stops and looks back over his shoulder.

THE A-LISTER (CONT'D)
 (to Willie)
 And hey... Dix. Make sure not to
 edit out ---

The A-Lister plucks a prop rose from nearby on the set, and hands it to Willie.

THE A-LISTER (CONT'D)
 The romance.

Willie looks disillusioned with men in general, and especially this particular advance.

WILLIE
 (disgusted)

Ugh.

THE A-LISTER
 (a disappointed beat)
 No? Well, maybe later on down the
 road.

The A-Lister continues his oblivious and self-satisfied walk toward the set. He stops by the dwarves, who use Drew's \$20 bill to do a line of something, and then set it on fire. Drew sees the whole thing unfold, and a dwarf flips him off. Drew is horribly hurt by the gesture.

Feeling a frenzy of new energy, the A-Lister looks around and sees where else on the film set might needs his special attention and activity. He seems to be down to shoot footage of just about anything as he calls off randomly into the void:

THE A-LISTER (CONT'D)
Ready, camera, action!

It's increasingly unclear whether or not the A-Lister still has a solid grip on reality, but nobody else with him is really in a solid enough mental state themselves to say whether or not his behavior is any worse or different than from what it usually is.

WILLIE
Is he always like that?

VISHAL
Like what?

WILLIE
You know.

VISHAL
Oh, he's a bundle of energy, that's for sure.

WILLIE
Is that what we're calling it?

VISHAL
Seems to me he has his good moments and his bad. His whiles and his ways.

WILLIE
Hm. Well, keep him awhile away from me, from now on. Something isn't quite right about him.

A short awkward pause ensues. Drew is clearly under the influence and having a hard time processing reality. He remains shut.

VISHAL
I have noticed that he has been on a lot of hallucinogens, really, since we met him.

WILLIE
Gotchaaa...

THE A-LISTER
(at quite a distance, but
apparently overhearing
them)
No more than usual.

WILLIE

(quieter, ushering Vishal
and Drew closer)

Just... be careful with him. I'm
not sure he's really invested in
the same vision as us.

VISHAL

You don't think so?

WILLIE

If he was, don't you think he'd be
getting on the plane to India with
us?

VISHAL

Maybe he just trusts us to get the
job done?

WILLIE

Does he really seem like the kind
of guy who would blindly put his
full faith and trust into complete
amateurs who have never done this
before? With the fate of a multi-
million dollar production?

THE A-LISTER

(no way he could have
possibly heard, but
sensing from a distance,
shouting)

You know what I feel with you guys?
Complete and total trust.

What at first seems like a response to Willie's question is
soon found to be a case of mistaken identity, as the A-Lister
was actually looking and speaking to the group of little
people hanging around smoking from the bong on the set.

VISHAL

Maybe he's just unorthodox?

Drew watches on as in the near distance the A-Lister cracks
himself up by whispering what one could only assume is an
incredibly dirty joke into a horse's ear at the make-shift
stable. Drew has been immobile, but he seems to have somehow
heard the joke that the A-Lister just told, and begins
cracking up himself.

DREW

That, is probably... an
understatement.

WILLIE

Really, Vishal? Unorthodox? Elton John is unorthodox... This... Well, something else entirely is going on here.

VISHAL

Perhaps he's just a bad judge of character?

Drew is now seen meditating with his eyes closed, and looks quite zen.

DREW

That would imply that we're not going to produce a great ending.

VISHAL

Hm, that doesn't seem right.

DREW

No, it doesn't. All things end.

Vishal sighs and a moment passes.

VISHAL

Now that I think about it, Willie, he did mention something about laundering money.

WILLIE

Oh, now that's interesting.

Drew's trip takes an obvious turn toward the foreboding. He is cracking under the pressure of expectations nobody but himself would ever even conceive of subjecting him to. His meditation is broken.

DREW

Oh, man. That's it, isn't it?

Vishal and Willie look at Drew confusedly. Drew has taken on a look of pure stress.

DREW (CONT'D)

(panicking a bit)

Are we in with the fucking sharks here, Vishal? Are we in way over our fucking heads into something so fucking deep that we will never even begin to comprehend where we were when we started figuring out this entire stupid concept in the first place?

Vishal looks in puzzlement back at Drew.

WILLIE

(slowly)

That may have been the first thing
you've said that's made sense to me
this entire flippin' *Bhang Tour*.

DREW

Right?

DREW (CONT'D)

Oh man, you don't think he's gonna
mess up our movie, do you?

Drew looks back toward the A-Lister, who is now free-basing
another unknown substance from the bong with some other
haggard looking crew members and little people near a fire-
in-a-barrel type situation that has sprung up. Some of the
people appear to be homeless. The A-Lister is getting footage
of them in between rips.

VISHAL

That would not be cool.

DREW

Oh man, we're the fucking writers
of Hollywood's hottest screenplay,
and I feel we are literally the
most powerless people on the entire
planet. Are they gonna fuck this up
for us, Willie?

WILLIE

Not on purpose, I don't think. He
does seem genuinely passionate
about lifting these little people
up. Maybe he's got a thing with
them, you know?

The A-Lister can be seen attempting to high-five a little
person in the distance, and missing due to a misjudgment of
trajectories and angles.

DREW

True... But he also has a... thing
with a German Shepherd playing
Gandalfi's legendary horse... so...
you tell me Vishal, was that part
of your initial vision?

Vishal sighs, conceding things may have strayed a bit from
the "simplicity" of his original idea.

Willie is seen admiring the German Shepherd, still in mo-cap suit, who is running about freely on the set with little supervision.

WILLIE
(adoringly)
Gotta admit though, the dog does
looks super cute in that mo-cap
suit.

Drew is overwhelmed by the german shepherd's cuteness. Drew begins to become heavily emotional, in a good way. In fact, it seems like things are turning up for his trip.

The happiness is short lived, as we see the dog corner a jockey and force the jockey to attempt to crawl over the fence into the make-shift stable.

He is too short to do so, and as distant screams are heard from the set, by the last sight we see from Drew's perspective, the dog has a near fatal advantage on the jockey --- little people can be vaguely seen cheering on the dog and the dwarves are running a gambling ring.

DREW
(ventilating)
Oh man. This whole thing... is just
a bit heavier than I thought it
would be. Breathe, Drew. Just
Breathe.

Drew is seen slowly accepting that he had no idea what he was really signing up for with these people. We can see his unfortunate progression as he plays some quick mental gymnastics with himself, trying to rationalize a universe in which any of this story could possibly exist at all.

VISHAL
(non-chalantly, but with
some concern for his
buddy)
What's up, man? You okay?

DREW
This is crazy to you too, right,
man?

VISHAL
Well I didn't hit the bong just
now. But in general, I don't know
anymore. I'm just sort of going
with it, like you said I should.

DREW
(incredulous)
Going with it? Oh man, how can you
just be going with this crazy shit?
This is not what I was talking
about!

Vishal shrugs and opens up his backpack and three thermoses
are seen inside.

VISHAL
(offering Drew a thermos)
Bhang?

DREW
No man. I think I need to sober up
a bit. Sleep, maybe. I'm not sure
what's even in my system at this
point.

WILLIE
I'll have one.

Vishal nonchalantly passes Willie a thermos of Bhang.

VISHAL
Calm down. Look around, man. It's
just another day on set, dude.

DREW looks around and for a brief moment everything and
everybody seems to be suddenly totally normal on set. The A-
Lister and the crew are busy filming a scene now taking place
between Vidu and the motion-capture dog. It is adorable and
couldn't help but make anybody who saw it want to smile.

DREW
Alright, maybe it's just me, then,
right? Maybe everything is totally
normal, and this is just a normal,
every day part of the crazy ass
method living, writing, whatever
world. Is that so? Are we here
permanently? That can't be real, is
it?

VISHAL
It sort of seems to be what's going
on up to this point and I don't
really see signs of it changing any
time soon, if that's what you're
asking.

Drew takes in a deep, deep breath of air for the first time
in what seems like ages.

DREW

Well... fuck, I guess that's it then.

VISHAL

What's it?

DREW

My life, man. This is gonna be my life until we finish this movie, man. I've gotta get out. There has to be a way out.

VISHAL

Relax dude, once we get to India, then we'll have our ending, and it will all somehow make sense, all right?

DREW

You're sure about that?

VISHAL

Not sure we have much choice anyway. I...

The earlier feel-good scene between Vidu and the dog is long gone. The A-Lister is now seen in the distance getting into a physical altercation and screaming match with one of the hobos near the trash barrel fire.

VISHAL (CONT'D)

I don't want to get on his bad side. And like you said, what's the worst that can happen, right?

Willie immediately interjects.

WILLIE

(with conviction)

I don't want to get trafficked, for one...

Can we please just acknowledge and put out there that shit is not okay at all for women in India?

VISHAL

(man-splaining)

Nobody's going to traffick you, Willie, it's not like that where we're going.

WILLIE

Kind of seems it's a bit like that everywhere anybody goes, Vishal.

Drew and Vishal sigh and nod sadly in response to Willie's comment.

VISHAL

Listen... Let's just try and make best of our situation, alright?

DREW

What is our situation, again, exactly?

Vishal tosses Drew one of the portable Bhang thermoses he has been carrying with him in his backpack.

VISHAL

Our situation is we are about to walk through the airport high as kites on our way to an Indian wedding. What could be better?

Drew and Willie feign enthusiasm, but have no real frame of reference and frankly, look kind of tired.

WILLIE

Yay!

Drew looks totally freaked out, which makes Willie suddenly look more nervous than she did before.

WILLIE (CONT'D)

I think?

VISHAL

(excitedly)

Oh, Willie! You have no idea! You just sit back, drink the last of that Bhang and we'll be watching this story write itself in no time.

DREW

(full of regret)

Just like Jack's story wrote itself?

WILLIE

Wait, what happened to Jack?

VISHAL

Nothing!

DREW
WE happened to him!

VISHAL
No news is good news, right?

DREW
Done for!

WILLIE
What the hell?!? Vishal?!

VISHAL
You said we had to leave him! Act 1 character.

DREW
I think I was wrong, man.

DREW (CONT'D)
(remorsefully)
He was... he was my spiritual
sherpa.

VISHAL
Seriously, just relax you guys.
Jack is fine --- just like we're
gonna be fine. We just have to let
karma do its thing.

DREW
I think I may have gotten karma and
dharma switched up a bit when we
last spoke about this, man.

VISHAL
Oh, no...

Willie eyes Vishal & Drew with concern, looking more
uncertain by the minute.

WILLIE
Do you two have a backup plan? In
case Karma doesn't work out?

DREW
Apparently we only need one plan --
- and it's just the fucking
craziest of all possible plans from
what I can gather.

VISHAL

Do you wanna make adult films
forever, Drew, or do you wanna goto
India and return as a legend?
Remember man, the hero's journey.

DREW

Goddamn it.

WILLIE

(decisively)

I think I'm gonna make my own
itinerary for at least part of the
trip if you guys don't mind.

VISHAL

Really?

WILLIE

Really.

DREW

You're really gonna go along with
this lunatic, Willie? You're
bonkers too. Well, let's do it
then! I can't take the "reality" in
this country any more.

After composing himself a bit, Drew and his concerned trip-
parents are seen departing for the airport.

DISSOLVE TO:

INT. FLIGHT TO INDIA

On a flight to India, in a packed plane, we see Vishal next
to Drew and Willie. He wants to lean on Willie's shoulder but
she is sleeping against the window. Instead, he ends up using
Drew's shaggy hair as a quasi-pillow. We are suddenly
immersed in his dream.

DISSOLVE TO:

EXT. CALCUTTA, WEST BENGAL, AN OLD MOVIE THEATER

A well dressed and well-to-do man, VISHAL'S FATHER is seen
leaving the movie theater at a film premier in the evening
accompanied by his family of four. Fans come up to him and
ask for his autograph. We see the name he signs matches the
marquee on the theater. The Father waves goodbye to his
adoring fans as he boards an elaborate tuk-tuk, manned by an
INDIAN LITTLE PERSON.

Along a seemingly normal ride home, a storm begins above, and in the deluge, they are accosted by two other tuk-tuks and overtaken in a scene reminiscent of *Octopussy*.

The family's tuk-tuk topples over causing significant damages and injury. The Father and the little person stand up from the wreckage and engage in hand-to-hand combat with SIX ADVERSARIES while Vishal crawls from the remains of the tuk-tuk and surveys the scene.

His MOTHER has been crushed in the incident. His GRANDPA is severely injured and clinging to life.

GRANDPA
(between gasps, to young
Vishal)
Fly, you fool!

The last sight Vishal sees is his Father and the little person being stabbed in the middle of the street fight. Vishal awakes in a sweat.

CUT TO:

INT. FLIGHT TO INDIA

Drew and Willie are watching Vishal with concern.

WILLIE
Hey Vishal, we're landing...

DREW
Everything... uh, okay man? You
were breathing kind of heavy there.

Vishal instinctively replies, without inspiring confidence.

VISHAL
Yeah! No problem here!

Vishal sniffs and gathers himself, tears welling in his eyes.

CUT TO:

EXT. NETAJI SUBHAS CHANDRA BOSE INTERNATIONAL AIRPORT - NIGHT

The humid Kolkata air is thick with smog and car horns as Vishal, Willie, and Drew step outside. The airport is a chaotic mess of rickshaws, tuk-tuks, and classic yellow Ambassador taxis.

Drew is already sweating.

DREW
(dramatic)
Dude. We just landed, and I'm
already getting *Delhi Belly*.

VISHAL
We're in Kolkata.

DREW
Same thing.

Vishal shakes his head, spotting a bright yellow Ambassador taxi pulling up.

A driver in aviator sunglasses and a crisp white shirt steps out, beaming.

AMBASSADOR DRIVER
(smiling)
Hello, sir! Best rate in Kolkata!
Meter always fair!

Willie eyes him skeptically.

WILLIE
I dunno. This feels a little—

Before she can finish, Vishal enthusiastically tosses their bags into the trunk.

VISHAL
C'mon. It's a classic Ambassador cab! You gotta trust a guy in aviators.

Willie sighs but follows. Drew lingers. Vishal and Willie put their bags in the trunk of the cab.

DREW
(narrowing his eyes)
Yeah, I think I'll keep my bags
with me...

The Ambassador driver suddenly yanks the door shut, locking Drew out.

AMBASSADOR DRIVER
(smiling, to Drew)
No room! Next taxi, sir!

Before any of their party can protest—the cab peels out, leaving Drew behind.

INT. AMBASSADOR TAXI - NIGHT

The inside of the otherwise shitty taxi is suspiciously clean, like it's just been detailed.

Willie leans toward Vishal, whispering.

WILLIE

(low)

Okay, this is some *Taken* shit.

Vishal waves her off.

VISHAL

(low)

Relax. Ambassador cabs are a Kolkata institution.

Vishal chuckles, but then—he notices the meter.

It starts ticking normally... then jumps from 200 to 2,500 rupees.

VISHAL (CONT'D)

(freezing)

Uh...

Willie leans forward.

WILLIE

(excuse me)

What's up with your meter?

The driver turns around, smiling.

AMBASSADOR DRIVER

Ahh... the meter, she is... how you say? Very dynamic!

Vishal and Willie exchange a look of sheer panic.

They reach for the door handles. Locked.

WILLIE

(laughing nervously)

Okay. Okay, yeah. So... we're getting trafficked. Cool.

VISHAL

(reluctant)

Okay, *maybe* the sunglasses were a red flag.

The driver suddenly veers off the main road, taking them down a dark alley near the Hooghly River.

WILLIE
How many rupees do you have?

VISHAL
I only have five grand.

Willie & Vishal look at the meter, which has surpassed 5,000.
Vishal addresses the cab driver:

VISHAL (CONT'D)
Um, we need to get off here.

AMBASSADOR DRIVER
We're not there yet! Two more
kilometers.

VISHAL
Your meter's broken dude! We can't
pay this much!!!

AMBASSADOR DRIVER
Big problem! You no pay, I take you
somewhere nice—talk to my boss.
Maybe you work it off?

Willie and Vishal look at each other.

WILLIE
(whispers)
Okay, we're getting trafficked.

VISHAL
(flat)
Yeah, I think we're in Act 2 of my
dad's movie right now.

Willie leans in, dead serious.

WILLIE
Um... What the hell are you even
talking about? Forget it.

What's our plan?

VISHAL
Think fast, act faster.

WILLIE
That's not a plan, that's a *fortune*
cookie!

EXT. LOADING DOCK - NIGHT

The taxi slows near a deserted loading dock.

The driver steps out, heading toward a group of sketchy-looking men waiting near a tea stall.

Inside the taxi, Vishal and Willie whisper frantically.

WILLIE (CONT'D)
Okay, we need a weapon. What do we have?

Vishal scans the backseat.

A plastic Jesus figurine on the dashboard. A sweaty leather wallet. A cricket bat shoved between the seats. Willie's eyes lock onto the cricket bat.

She pulls it free like a warrior claiming *Excalibur*.

VISHAL
(whispering)
You know how to use that?

WILLIE
(gripping the bat)
Vishal.. I've seen *Lagaan* four times.

Vishal nods, impressed.

VISHAL
Respect.

EXT. LOADING DOCK - NIGHT

The men finish their chais and spit on the ground, before approaching the cab.

THE BACK DOORS OF THE AMBASSADOR CAB EXPLODE OPEN!

Willie launches out first, swinging the cricket bat like a maniac. She cracks the driver in the back of the legs, sending him sprawling.

Vishal panics, grabs a handful of rupees from the front seat—then immediately regrets it.

VISHAL (CONT'D)
Oh god... I don't know why I'm doing this!

He hurls the rupees into the air in pure terror.

Money flies everywhere. The sketchy men instantly abandon the driver, scrambling for his grip of cash.

Willie spins the cricket bat like a martial arts staff.

WILLIE
(low, to Vishal)
I'm keeping this.

VISHAL
(fully panicked)
Yeah, whatever, JUST RUN!
RUN!

They sprint down the alleyway, dodging food carts and startled rickshaw drivers.

EXT. OLD KOLKATA STREETS - NIGHT

Willie and Vishal finally duck into a hidden courtyard, panting.

A nearby shrine flickers with candlelight.

For a moment, they just breathe.

Then-Willie starts laughing.

VISHAL (CONT'D)
What?

WILLIE
You, man. You look like you just
got born again.

Vishal pauses, processing. He has just escaped the same fate his father didn't. Willie watches his face shift.

WILLIE (CONT'D)
(softer)
Vishal?

He meets her eyes. For the first time, there's no sarcasm, no performance. Just, something real.

Suddenly, a loud horn blares.

DREW (O.S.)
Hey, "Fellowship"?! Way to ditch
your friend.

Vishal and Willie turn. Drew is pulling up in a rickshaw, holding two bhang lassis.

DREW
Ahhh... C'mon... Get in. I got us a
ride. Wedding's about to start.

Willie and Vishal exchange a final look before climbing in.
As they pull away, Willie nudges Vishal's shoulder.

WILLIE
(low)
Next time, I pick the cab.

VISHAL
(grinning)
Deal.

FADE TO:

EXT. MODERN-DAY KOLKATA - RAHUL & JANVHI'S WEDDING

A lavish, over-the-top traditional Indian wedding unfolds in a blur of colors, music, and madness.

A white horse adorned in gold and red silk trots through the crowd. Rahul sits on top, beaming, holding what appears to be a child in front of him.

Upon closer inspection... it's a little person (or a jockey, depending on who you asked that fateful day).

The wedding procession is grand, with Dhol drummers, swaying flower canopies, and thirty-plus family members in extravagant attire.

Vishal, Drew, and Willie stand among the chaos. Vishal & Drew are dressed in borrowed kurtas that fit them awkwardly, while Willie adorns a tasteful saree.

Drew and Vishal are already drinking bhang, passing the milky-green cannabis-infused drink between them.

Willie watches them with mild amusement, arms crossed.

WILLIE
(eyeing the drink)
You sure you guys can handle this?

DREW
Offense taken.

VISHAL
We're professionals.

They clink their bhang glasses like they're at a frat party and chug.

Willie sighs and takes a tentative sip.

WILLIE
(quietly, to herself)
If I die, I'm haunting you both.

Drew and Vishal high-five in unearned self-satisfaction.
Willie watches, shaking her head.

The wedding continues. Janvhi arrives, a vision in her ornate saree, her hands decorated with intricate mehndi.

The ceremony progresses, the bags under Vishal and Drew's eyes growing darker as their bhang consumption increases.

Willie, sharper than both of them combined, remains aware, her eyes scanning the scene, always clocking things. She notices a few discreet cameras filming the event—more than she'd expect at a wedding. She narrows her eyes but says nothing.

EXT. MODERN DAY KOLKATA - RAHUL'S WEDDING RECEPTION -
CONTINUOUS

Janvhi chimes a champagne flute, signaling a toast.

JANVHI
Thank you all for coming out to our
wedding. I know some of you have
come a very long way to be here.

(with love in her eyes)
When I first met Rahul, a Bong,
with a Bong, who loved Bhang... I
wasn't sure it was ever going to
work out.

After all, my parents have never
even had a Bong... and they don't
even like Bongs!

Laughs can be heard from the wedding attendees. JANVHI's PARENT's smile but then immediately begin whispering with hints of disapproval into one another's ears.

JANVHI (CONT'D)
It can be scary getting married. So
much uncertainty. But when you
know, you know...
(toward Rahul lovingly, not
realizing she is about to
inflict serious injury)
(MORE)

JANVHI (CONT'D)
 And I knew our love was true, when
 I asked Rahul to give up his Bong
 for me. And... He did.

Rahul's face grimaces with pain as he hears his wife speak of
 a still fresh wound.

CONTINUOUS EXT. - CLOSE UP ON RAHUL

THE WIND (V.O)
 (heard only by Rahul)
Precious.

We focus back on Janvhi.

JANVHI
 (smiling)
 I hope I haven't robbed you
 of your sense of *Bonghood*.

The wedding attendees laugh, but Rahul looks insecure.

JANVHI (CONT'D)
 Anyway, as you all know. We are a
 bit progressive in our family. And
 as you also may know, we are un-
 abashed stoners.

So! Please join me if you will, in
 raising your Bhang to the one and
 only Bong I will ever need in my
 life.

We see the wedding tables having bhang poured for them in
 slow motion at their tables. Drew & Vishal begin drinking,
 licking every drop from their lips, smiling in satisfaction.
 Willie follows suit but with an air of caution. Time passes
 as the scenes of the wild wedding continue behind them.

One partygoer tries to bring Vishal & Drew back into the
 moment by snapping in front of them. The tactic is
 ineffective. Other random Indian Grandpas & Grandmas pass
 them by at the party:

RANDOM BABA
 Man, they are *bhanged* out.

RANDOM NANI
 (speaking to her daughter)
 This is what happens when you get
 too high.

In the midst of their bhang trip, reality seems to distort and shimmer.

Willie notices Vishal's eyes go wide as he stares into the distance. She follows his gaze.

The C-Lister & Hollywood Midget are in the background, shaking hands with rich-looking Indian businessmen. They look to still be dressed as though in character for a movie.

Willie's brows furrow. She tries to get a better look, but the scene shifts again.

Unsure of whether or not what they saw was real, and unable to get a better look, Vishal, Drew, and Willie soon find themselves instead as part of a group sitting in a line surrounding the dance floor, all of the line drinking bhang.

A song begins to play and people are seen taking to the dance floor. The topic of the song is the Bong being filled with Bhang by Bongs. The Bong has suddenly appeared. Vishal and Drew laugh to themselves, assuming they've imagined it.

DREW

(bhanged out of his mind)

Just like *Big Lebowski*, am I right?

VISHAL

(bhanged out of his mind)

Nah man... this... this shit is
unto itself entirely.

DREW

(realized)

Just like *Bhang Tour*...

They are *too high*.

Meanwhile, The C-Lister and Vidu are seen dancing with the Bong amongst the Indian dancers, singing and starring as characters in:

THE BHANG SONG

(A BOLLYWOOD-ESQUE VERSION OF THE
THONG SONG W/ SPECIAL LYRICS)

The action of the song mirrors the action of *Bhang Tour*. The writers point at The C-Lister and Vidu and begin cracking up, no longer trusting their sense of reality. Although there have always been video cameras capturing the wedding, there suddenly seem to be a lot more, and of a higher quality.

During the dance, the C-Lister suddenly grabs Willie from the audience and begins dancing with her.

Willie seems to be enjoying herself after her initial reluctance. The C-Lister, surprisingly, is shown to be a phenomenal dancer, and she is having a blast simply because the thing is so weird. The bong makes its way across the room, a trail of smoke tailing it along the way, from the C-Lister to Vidu and finally to Willie. Willie hits the Bong and smoke completely fills the stage, obfuscating Willie and the others from sight.

Drew and Vishal's last memory is a jockey sitting down next to them with a very tired, or very stoned horse. For a moment, it appears as though the horse is wearing a motion-capture suit. Reality swells and bevels.

FADE TO BLACK.

EXT. A FIELD IN KOLKATA

Eventually waking up out of a haze, Vishal surveys the scene of the wedding grounds. Nobody else is there, except for Drew, and the horse who is still passed out on the ground next to them. The wedding appears to be long gone. They are just in a random field.

Vishal is still *fucking high*, and can't believe what he thinks he now sees: a MAN IN A MOTION CAPTURE SUIT, hobbling stealthily like Gollum, in the distance. Vishal rubs his eyes, and upon opening them again, the man is gone.

VISHAL

Where are we??? Drew... wake up
man. Where's Willie?

Willie is nowhere in sight.

Shaking it off as a bad afterglow, Vishal looks down at his phone to see hundreds of missed calls.

VISHAL (CONT'D)

Oh shit, she's probably looking for
us or needing help...

Vishal frowns as he sees that none of them are from Willie. They are all from the A-Lister.

VISHAL (CONT'D)

What in the world?

Vishal returns the A-Lister's call. The A-Lister is irate when he answers.

THE A-LISTER (V.O.)

Where the fuck are you guys? I've been trying to get in touch with you.

VISHAL

Oh, we were just at the wedding. What's going on?

THE A-LISTER (V.O.)

Just at the wedding? What the fuck? You have got to be fucking kidding me.

VISHAL

Well, I mean, it's an Indian wedding. They last a week.

THE A-LISTER (V.O.)

A week? A week?! You said it'd take a day! What on earth are you guys doing over there? Things are fucked on set over here. Totally fucked.

VISHAL

Wait... wait...

The A-Lister starts hurriedly speaking, but his voice fades into the background. The last words we hear but can barely make out are.

THE A-LISTER (V.O.).

(muffled)

I repeat, we have lost our midget.

Vishal's jaw slowly starts to drop, as in the distance, an aged and battle-scarred INDIAN LITTLE PERSON begins crossing the field toward him. Vishal is entranced.

VISHAL

I'm going to have to call you back.

Vishal hangs up the phone. We recognize MONTU, the same little person who was presented to the audience in the opening scene, but without the distinguishing acid-scarring that marked his face earlier.

Vishal is in disbelief. Drew is just waking up as he sees Vishal touch the little person's haggard face.

VISHAL (CONT'D)

But... You're dead. You... died.

MONTU
(laughing hoarsely)
Rest easy son, you've had a busy
day. You're fortunate to be all in
one piece.

Drew, coming to, starts to take inventory of his scattered belongings and the scene at-large.

DREW
(whispering)
Just like *A New Hope*.

Vishal is dumbfounded and begins to tear up, his hand still on Montu's cheek.

Drew becomes slowly more alert to the strangely intimate sight and responds with a massive yawn. He takes a moment to rub his eyes and attempts to assess the scene. Observing a little person, he nods once attempting to convince himself it's not a dream, before shaking his head furiously and putting his notebook over his head, which is just lying on the ground.

DREW (CONT'D)
I can't possibly still be this
fucking high, man.

Drew re-opens one eye slowly. Nothing has changed.

VISHAL
(to Montu)
I can't believe it's really you.

DREW
(suddenly becoming alert)
Vishal? Is this real? Oh man. I
don't even know what's real
anymore.

VISHAL
It's real, Drew.

DREW
So you can also see this hilarious
fucking dwarf that just showed up?

VISHAL
Yes, I see him, Drew.

DREW
Just like *Lord of the Rings*, dude.
Just like *Lord of the Rings*.

VISHAL

Drew... This is Montu. He's a real person. He was our family driver growing up. This has nothing to do with *Lord of The Rings*, man.

DREW

Oh, no shit?

VISHAL

(to Montu, beginning to cry, with anger in his voice)

But... I don't understand. I saw you and papa die. The tuk-tuk spilling over. The attackers tearing my mother from me. Baba's last words.

DREW

(in surprise)

Woah. Is this like, a super dark, *Batman*-esque kind of backstory?

VISHAL

I... I don't understand. I saw you and papa get stabbed.

DREW

Oh damn!

MONTU

Vishal. Lots of people get stabbed. It doesn't mean that they're dead forever.

VISHAL

Huh? Oh. Well... I mean... I had never really thought of that, I guess.

MONTU

And your father...
(pausing for impact)
He lives too.

A short silence occurs. Vishal looks stunned. Drew breaks the silence after giving an appropriate amount of grace period.

DREW
 (to Vishal, stunned)
 Holy shit, you mean to tell me
 you've been method writing this
 midget thing all along dude?

Vishal nods slowly.

DREW (CONT'D)
 You should have totally told me
 that, bro! I didn't know you had
 like, a thing like that goin' on,
 you know?

Drew realizes everything he assumed he knew about his co-writer has potentially been ill-conceived up unto this point.

While maintaining a new sense of concern and locked-on eye contact with Vishal, Drew opens his notebook. We see him jot down a few notes onto a list:

- + childhood trauma (lots?)
- + tuk-tuk stabbing. :-(
- + midget returns to life
 - + (how / when does he die?)
- + father issues?

After a moment of pondering the magnitude of this new reality, Drew further surveys his surroundings.

DREW (CONT'D)
 Hey. Has anybody seen Willie?

MONTU
 Who?

VISHAL
 Willie, she's a friend of ours. She
 was with us at the wedding. I
 haven't seen her since I woke up,
 Drew.

MONTU
 It was just you two and the horse
 when I got here.

Montu looks at the passed out horse.

MONTU (CONT'D)
 I think your horse might be sick.

VISHAL
 He's just stoned.

MONTU
(skeptically)
Hm. If you say so.

DREW
(processing Montu's
existence)
So what's your deal?

MONTU
What do you mean, what's my deal?

DREW
What brings you out of the woodwork suddenly, huh? Why have you been pretending to be dead? Huh? I don't mean to break up the hunky-dory reunion here Vishal, but where I come from, pretending to be dead for someone's entire life is considered a shitty thing to do. We have cell phones these days, you guys could have at least called. Sent a text, hm?

MONTU
(annoyed, to Vishal,
pointing at Drew)
Vishal, who the hell is this guy?

Vishal can be seen evaluating his friendship with Drew, and indeed, possibly evaluating Drew's entire life and worth as a human being. His expression is painted all over his face.

Anybody witnessing Vishal's face at that moment could quite plainly tell, that Vishal was torn about whether or not to vouch for Drew in India, where people knew and generally liked him --- Vishal, the guy who came up with the beloved *Bhang Tour*. Vishal, separate from Drew, a nobody as of yet. Another floating speck in an ocean of billions of people.

MONTU (CONT'D)
Is he gonna be cool, or do I have to take care of him?

DREW
(agitated, with hands
gesturing air quotes)
What do you mean: "Take care of me?"

MONTU
I don't want to have to make this a thing, Vishal.

VISHAL
Drew, calm down man.

DREW
Fucking hell. You're telling ME to
calm down?

VISHAL
You don't know this guy, man.

DREW
(enraged with Vishal)
Are you fuckin' serious with me
right now?

VISHAL
Dead serious, man.

Drew looks at Vishal with a bit of hatred in his eyes for the first time in their entire friendship.

DREW
I don't know what to fucking say to
you.

VISHAL
Just let it be, man.

Montu flips off Drew, which seems to hurt Drew's feelings more than we might expect.

DREW
He may only be half my size, but so
far he's turning out to be every
bit the oversized bully.

VISHAL
Yeah, he is, Drew. But you know
what? He's also an old friend of
mine, and if what he says about my
dad is true, we're going to need
his help, right?

Drew sniffs a bit, feeling sorry for himself, but has mostly calmed down.

VISHAL (CONT'D)
Right?

DREW
I guess so.

MONTU

(abruptly, with surprising
command and an air of
gravity)

Some things about your world view
are going to probably have to
change a bit, okay?

VISHAL

(comfortingly, toward Drew)

Okay?

Drew sobs and nods more out of fear than agreement, which causes an instinctual relaxation in Montu as he finds a sort of pleasure in Drew seemingly beginning to grasp his new limitations and ignorances when it comes to operating within the Indian culture of unspoken, understood, generational cues.

VISHAL (CONT'D)

(apologizing for Drew, to
Montu)

Sorry man, we've just been
reallllly bhanged out for what
apparently has been over a month
now, and things are still not quite
adding up for us yet this morning.

MONTU

(suddenly laughing and
changing his disposition
completely)

Oh, you guys have been drinking
Bhang?

Vishal and Drew nod.

MONTU (CONT'D)

(chortling)

Ha! Why didn't you just say so?!

Montu seems to have had a whole slew of his questions and reservations cleared up almost immediately.

MONTU (CONT'D)

Honestly, the entire conversation
up until this point makes much more
sense now that I know that. You
really should have led with that!

Not sure if they are being made fun of or not, Drew and Vishal just sort of nod and stupidly agree with what the little person has just said.

MONTU (CONT'D)

I didn't realize you guys had a thing going on.

(wiping a tear of joy from his eye)

Anyway, there's a lot we have to discuss, but we should keep moving. I'll tell you more as soon as it's safe. I'm afraid that we are being tracked.

Montu looks into the surrounding forest with distrust.

MONTU (CONT'D)

We need to get to Rishikesh. Your father will fill you in on more when we arrive.

Suddenly taking advantage of the sleeping horse's prone position, Montu expertly mounts the beast, waking it in the process. It stands up and Montu controls the horse instantly, with surprising ease and obvious experience.

DREW

(frankly, surprised)

What the hell? Are you some sort of jockey or something?

MONTU

Just a man whose done his time in the saddle.

VISHAL

We can't just leave Willie here. I mean... can we? Where is she?

VISHAL (CONT'D)

(suddenly more worried, to Drew)

Can you try calling her, man?

Drew selects "Dix" from the contacts in his phone. The call goes straight to voicemail.

DREW

No, luck, man. Straight to voicemail. You try?

Vishal also tries, but becomes frustrated as in between attempts to call Winnie, phone call after phone call begin to roll in from The A-Lister. Vishal rejects them as they come in.

Texts begin to roll in instead, also from the A-Lister.

THE A-LISTER (TEXT)
SOS. We have lost our midget.

THE A-LISTER (TEXT) (CONT'D)
I repeat. We have lost our midget.

VISHAL
(annoyed but reporting
faithfully)
He is really distraught... Looks
like Vidu left the set. It's
fucking falling apart without us
man.

DREW
(worried)
Vidu left?

VISHAL (TEXT)
(to the A-Lister)
Can we get it around it in editing?
CGI?

THE A-LISTER (TEXT)
(Drew & Vishal both
watching Vishal's phone)
We're not gonna George Lucas this
thing.

THE A-LISTER (TEXT) (CONT'D)
Have some fucking artistic
integrity.

DREW
(with conviction)
I agree, Vishal. Vidu's essential
to the plot! It's not like we can
just have him nearly entirely
missing from the first act. The
audience needs to develop a strong
emotional attachment in order for
his death to be impactful at the
end.

MONTU
Who dies?

	VISHAL	DREW
Nobody!		The midget!

MONTU
This is the film you're working on?

DREW

Yes sir!

MONTU

I see. Things are worse than we thought, if you've already written in the death of a little person. Come, we have no time to waste.

As if by using the force, Montu compels Vishal & Drew onto the back of the horse with him with but a few hand motions. They seem unable to resist the persuasion.

INT. KOLKATA TRAIN STATION

Vishal is still distraught about Willie as the party approaches the train station.

VISHAL

We can't just leave her here, Drew!

DREW

We don't even know if she is *here*, anymore, man.

VISHAL

Oh my God. Fuck my life, dude. What if she's been trafficked?

DREW

I highly doubt she's getting trafficked. You know Willie. She's as strong as they come man. I'm sure she's taking no shit and doing whatever is best, wherever she is.

VISHAL

I promised I'd keep her safe, man...

Montu grunts at the distracted young men. He has purchased the tickets for the party but can not quite reach the dispensing tray. Montu looks to Drew for help, and is slightly embarrassed about suddenly needing his assistance after threatening him moments earlier.

MONTU

A bit of help?

DREW

Oh, lookin' for these, eh? Here ya go, my lil' guy.

Drew has suddenly turned the tables, and taunts Montu with the ticket, holding it just out of his reach.

Vishal observes Drew's stupid, petty actions and sighs.

VISHAL
(breaking down)
I'm not sure I'm cut out for this
method writing stuff after all.

DREW
Ah, don't say that, buddy.

MONTU
Come on! Give me the ticket, the
train is leaving.

DREW
(still taunting Montu with
the ticket)
All you've got to do is reach it.

VISHAL (ASIDE)
Come on Drew, seriously now. What
do you think we should do?

DREW
(still holding the ticket
just out of reach of
Montu's outstretched arm)
You heard what the A-Lister said...
If we really lost a month worth of
time on our bender then she could
be halfway to Gondor by now.

VISHAL
So what do we do?

DREW
If we were in *Lord of The Rings*,
we'd move on and meet up with her
again later on down the road.

TRAIN STATION P.S.A (V.O.)
Last call for Rishikesh.

MONTU
We need to go.

VISHAL
(sighing, renewing his
resolve)
Alright, then. Let's do this.

Drew still refuses to hand the tickets down to Montu. Montu, suddenly fed up, grabs Drew's testicles and Drew immediately falls to the ground and drops the tickets.

MONTU

Not so big now are you, doubling?

VISHAL

Montu! Let him go!

DREW

I'm sorry, I'm sorry!

MONTU

We need to go.

Montu throws Drew's ticket down at his crumbled body with scorn. He grabs Drew by the collar and begins pulling him toward the train door.

MONTAGE - CONTINUOUS

A quick montage is shown of Montu, Vishal, and Drew taking various forms of transport to cross the country. Along the way, scenes of Montu & Vishal dancing, and laughing happily are shown, while Drew develops a jealousy and becomes obviously more upset with the relationship as time progresses. After what seems like logistical ages, they find themselves finally in Rishikesh, at a train station.

ACT 3

CUT TO:

EXT. RISHIKESH - EXITING THE TRAIN STATION

The writers and Montu disembark the train and hail a tuk-tuk, which we see take them to a secondary location, a simple and inconspicuous abode - like Yoda's - an obscure dwelling of sorts.

EXT. RISHIKESH ABODE - NIGHT

Vishal's father walks out with a cane, hobbling.

VISHAL

Papa! You're alive?

VISHAL'S FATHER

Yes, my son. I'm sorry it has been so long. I kept my presence a secret in order to protect you... and in order to die famous.

I hope one day you can understand. It's better to die a legend in India than chase varying titles of mediocrity elsewhere.

But for now, we have much to discuss. Come. Come inside.

EXT. CALCUTTA, WEST BENGAL, A TOWN SQUARE

We flashback to the night from Vishal's dream, this time from his father's perspective. His father is narrating the ordeal. The flashback has the quality of a noir film.

VISHAL'S FATHER (V.O.)

We had just left the premier of my latest film, *Little Bhangladesh*, when we noticed we were being followed.

We see two tuk-tuks begin to aggressively tail Vishal's Father's Tutuk.

VISHAL'S FATHER (V.O.) (CONT'D)

It quickly became clear that they were not my adoring fans. Things took a turn for the worse.

We see the tuk-tuk get run off the road.

VISHAL'S FATHER (V.O.) (CONT'D)
Things happened so fast.

As Vishal runs, the Father and Montu are seen in silhouette fighting against their adversaries, defeating them in heroic fashion, but not without sustaining heavy injuries. The fight scene would fit perfectly in a Quentin Tarantino movie, or *Sin City*.

VISHAL'S FATHER (V.O.) (CONT'D)
I was... injured to the point of
death... but Montu, little as he
is, was able enough.

The Father is shown incapacitated to the point of death. Montu is the only one who is still mobile, but he can not move without great physical strain. He has cuts across his face and is bleeding badly. Montu belabouredly crawls to the family's Grandpa, BABA GANDALFI.

BABA GANDALFI
(with subtitles)
Gangaaajal. [The Ganges]

The grandpa points to a chest within the tuk-tuk.

BABA GANDALFI (CONT'D)
Fill it from the Ganges.

Montu collects himself to his feet, and attempts to hoist the grandpa, but he shoos him away.

BABA GANDALFI (CONT'D)
If you take me, none of us will
live. The Bong can only preserve
life, it can not extend it.

Montu opens the chest, revealing the Bong. Heroic music plays, as the little person summons his last strength, taking the Bong to his adversaries' tuk-tuk. He drives to the Father, loads him into the vehicle and departs the scene. As Montu drives Vishal's father, we see him ferociously hit the bong. He holds in the smoke, and we get the sense that it is the force sustaining him just long enough to reach the Ganges.

VISHAL'S FATHER (V.O.)
Montu drove me to the sacred
Ganges. He used the bong filled
with that sacred water to heal me.

We see the Ganges river water being poured from the bong onto Vishal's Father's wounds. Healing them ala the holy grail from *Indiana Jones - The Last Crusade*.

CUT TO:

INT. RISHIKESH ABODE PRESENT DAY

Vishal and Drew sit across from Vishal's Father and Montu, in disbelief of the story.

VISHAL

Wait, a Bong? Like, a Bong Bong?

The Father and Montu nod in unison.

DREW

No fucking way. Like the Holy Grail in *Indiana Jones*?

VISHAL

(replying, instantly)

I was going to say the exact same thing.

VISHAL'S FATHER

You idiots.

The father strikes Vishal with his cane.

VISHAL'S FATHER (CONT'D)

The holy grail from *Indian Jones* was just an allegory for The Bong in real life. George Lucas is a method writer --- and hear me well, that Bong is, in one way or another, responsible for every great movie of the modern era, including my own. But of course, you know that. You are, after all, caretakers of the Bong now.

VISHAL

Wait. The Bong? You mean...

A wave of understanding washes over Vishal and Drew as Rahul's voice and memory come back to them:

INT. BASEMENT - EARLIER IN THE MOVIE

RAHUL (V.O.)
Don't let anything happen to the
Bong.

The epiphany reaches Vishal and Drew in slow-motion.

RAHUL (V.O.) (CONT'D)
(like an echo, slower each
time)
The Bong... The Bong... The Bong...

	VISHAL		DREW
The Bong!		The Bong!	

DREW (CONT'D)
Wait a minute, Vishal... the
wedding, you don't think...
(to himself, puzzled)
Was... he actually there?

VISHAL
We have to call back to HQ!

Vishal and Drew look down at Vishal's phone. There are 420 missed calls. They are all from the A-Lister. Vishal calls him and puts the conversation on speaker. The A-Lister is immediately in a bad mood.

VISHAL (CONT'D)
Hey, sorry we've missed your calls,
man. The industry gods have been
leading us on a wild adventure.
Tell us what is going on. What
happened?

THE A-LISTER (V.O.)

What happened? My writers went
AWOL, my Midget left the set,
jockeys have gone back on strike,
and all I have now are fucking
comedians out here Portlandia-ing
all over the place. Oh, yeah, and a
bunch of god-awful, disjointed
motion capture scenes.

The german shepherd is heard whimpering.

THE COMEDIAN (V.O.)
He's not talking about you, baby!

THE A-LISTER (V.O.)
No, of course not you baby.

INT. THE COMEDY STORE - SIMULTANEOUS

We see the A-Lister finish petting the german shepherd (still in costume) in a backroom at *The Comedy Store*, and begins gesturing toward an editor to move the slider forward and backward, before continuing:

THE A-LISTER
What am I even looking at? This is like... *The Room* meets the deleted scenes from *The Hobbit*. Oh my God, we are so fucked. This is the fucking *Fyre Festival* of films.

DREW (V.O.)
Where are you now?

THE A-LISTER
I'm at HQ... *The Comedy Store*. Where else would I be?

DREW (V.O.)
Tell me something. The Bong... is it still there? Is it still on top of the shrine?

THE A-LISTER
The Bong? Yeah the Bong is right here in the shrine.

The A-Lister surveys the two shrines. The *Hate Shrine* has been further defaced. There looks to be feces smeared over the Comedian's cut-out. The A-Lister stutter-steps for a moment. Something is off about the Bong.

THE A-LISTER (CONT'D)
Wait a minute... hold on a second guys.

He approaches the shrine and realizes slowly that what he thought was the Bong was actually a perspective painting on the wall, ala *Indiana Jones - The Last Crusade*. An illusion to the mind.

THE A-LISTER (CONT'D)
The Bong is gone. It was a fucking magic trick. Sorry, an illusion.

CUT TO:

INT. RISHIKESH ABODE

On the other end of the phone line, we see Vishal and Drew look at each other worriedly. Vishal moves to hang up despite The A-Lister's voice still coming through audibly (though muffled) on the line.

THE A-LISTER (V.O).
The Bong is gone!

We hear the Comedian's distant and barely audible voice.

THE COMEDIAN (V.O.)
I know! That's why we called them!

THE A-LISTER (V.O).
Not *that* bong! The Bong, Bong.
Where's the bong gone?

THE COMEDIAN
You want more Bhang?

The dialogue on the phone becomes garbled and Vishal manages to cut the line.

VISHAL'S FATHER
You two lost the Bong?!

The father whacks Vishal with his cane. Both he and MONTU mutter under their breath in a furious mix of Hindi and Bengali.

VISHAL'S FATHER (CONT'D)
Arey chtiyon ka Nobel prize jeetne nikle ho kya?!

SUBTITLES
What is this, huh? You out here trying to win the Nobel Prize for idiots?!

MONTU
Sharam se bolte jaachi-
aajke din lamba manush ke liye
ijjat shesh.

SUBTITLES
I've never been this ashamed... and I watched a tall man get stuck in a ceiling fan once.

Vishal and Drew both look clueless. They decide to ignore the insults.

VISHAL

No, no, no. Think about it Drew, we saw it at the wedding. I thought we bhang vision-quested that, but we didn't. The Bong isn't lost, it's here in India!

Our Gollum must be using our bong to create his own version of *Bhang Tour*, here.

Drew is somehow even more stupefied than he already was.

Vishal's father runs his finger through his curled mustache. He appears to be in a deep meditation.

VISHAL'S FATHER

Tell me about your screenplay, son. How does it go?

MONTAGE - VARIOUS

A montage is shown as the writer's exhaustedly describe and act out scenes from *Bhang Tour* for Vishal's Father, sometimes substituting in Montu for their script's little person. For a few of the scenes, a local street dog who has also been watching the action is seen being fit into Vishal's motion capture suit.

After their display, Vishal and Drew look toward the old man for validation. They are sorely disappointed.

VISHAL'S FATHER

It stinks. Continuity issues everywhere. And where's the ending? A movie is only as good as the ending. But all of those are just minor inconveniences in comparison to your larger problem.

VISHAL

(taken aback, hurt)
What's that?

VISHAL'S FATHER

Your movie is incredibly callous toward little people. You can't just have your lead little person die.

Montu nods a strong nod.

VISHAL'S FATHER (CONT'D)

It's bad enough you parade him around like some sort of circus-act Elijah Wood, but then, after all of the incredibly derivative Tolkien stuff, you are going to break canon and kill off your Frodo? Of course he left the set.

MONTU

(firmly)

I would too.

VISHAL

We just thought it might be nice to throw in a twist and break from the formula a bit-

Vishal's Father strikes him with his cane, interrupting him.

VISHAL'S FATHER

Quiet now. This will take all my power.

The Father insists on total silence while he lights up a joint and hotboxes the room, slightly spooking the two young men, before proceeding to astral-project via smoke to the room how The C-Lister's script is going to be playing out (imagined, but dead on).

VISHAL'S FATHER (V.O.)

If your Gollum has the bong, by now, he has fixed your script. The lead little person no longer dies. Per canon.

Montu nods happily in agreement.

VISHAL'S FATHER (V.O.) (CONT'D)

Your gollum will have convinced your little person to join him. After all, he doesn't die in The C-Lister's version.

Drew scribbles in his notebook: **Does the Midget have to die?** He pauses for a moment, before crossing out the line and phrasing anew: **Does the little person have to die?** He underlines his new phrasing several times.

VISHAL

(to Drew)

I guess that explains Vidu leaving the set.

VISHAL'S FATHER (V.O.)
 The C-Lister will be producing,
 writing, directing, and acting.

The boys start to snicker, before Vishal's father raises his cane again. This time Vishal is ready and stops the incoming blow. Overmatched in his old age, the Father gives up his attack, but with sagacity, continues.

VISHAL'S FATHER
 Fools! Don't underestimate the
 power of the Bong. No. I'm afraid
 Your gollum will be doing a great
 job.

CUT TO:

EXT. A MOVIE SET

A scene from Bhang Tour is shown in the astral projection, and the C-Lister is giving a phenomenal performance as Dhruv aka Samwise.

DHRUV AKA SAMWISE
 Vidu, the bhang is strong, but in
 the end, it's only a passing thing,
 this shadow. Even darkness must
 pass. A new day will come. And when
 the sun shines it will shine out
 the clearer.

In addition to acting, the C-Lister is simultaneously doing most other functions of a feature-film production. In general, the sets look authentically Indian, and the production seems to be of a much higher quality than anything we have seen out of the A-Lister's efforts.

Within the projection, filming is suddenly interrupted when he sees someone off set.

THE C-LISTER
 Hey, take five everybody! Our
 editor and I need to go over this
 scene a bit in private.

The C-Lister walks toward Willie, who is just off stage.

VISHAL
 (with excitement and dread)
 Willie! Drew! He's got Willie!

The C-Lister and Willie share a quick hug.

WILLIE

I just finished reading your changes. What you've done is amazing! How do you think of this stuff?

THE C-LISTER

As my friend Quentin would quote me on... 'I Steal from Every Movie Ever Made'

WILLIE

Making it a trio with a female third. Wow. It's like Hermione if she had depth. I even showed it to my mother. So, so inspirational.

THE C-LISTER

That means so much that you would say that. You should have seen the source material I had to work with. I had to rewrite the original writer's parts completely.

WILLIE

So much better since we saddled up together.

Vishal's jaw drops.

WILLIE (CONT'D)

(in awe, looking into Final Cut)
These shots you are getting... I've never seen anything like it.

THE C-LISTER

Ah, Dix. Like my disciples would repeat: 'The screen is a magic medium. It conveys emotions and moods that no other art form can hope to tackle.'

DREW

Is she totally selling us out, dude?

VISHAL

It can't be...

WILLIE

I couldn't agree more. And your commentary on the white-washing of the film industry and the racial inequity at the heart of the military-industrial complex. I think people are going to write papers about this in film school someday. This is more than a script. This is a manifesto!

THE C-LISTER

It's the kind of systemic change only a guy like me could create, I think.

Vishal interrupts the flow of the projection.

VISHAL

(huffing)

What?!? He stole all of that from me!

VISHAL'S FATHER

Get used to it kid, that's show biz for ya.

VISHAL

That doesn't seem like Willie.

DREW

Maybe the magic is wrong?

VISHAL'S FATHER

(to Vishal)

Vishal. Who the hell is this guy?

VISHAL

This is Drew, dad.

VISHAL'S FATHER

(to Drew)

So are you the expert on magic now?

DREW

No... I...

VISHAL'S FATHER

Can you do this sort of astral-projection thing I'm doing here?

DREW

(ashamed)

No, I can't.

VISHAL'S FATHER

That's what I thought. So how about you leave the commentary on magic to the people who actually know a thing or two about it, okay?

Silence fills the room. Drew looks awkward as hell.

VISHAL

(interrupting)

Wait, wait, wait? So if he's not playing the script's Gollum anymore, where is his Gollum?

Montu points through the window down a rocky path outside the abode, we see the Man in a Motion Capture Suit from the field earlier now hiding in plain sight against a boulder.

MONTU

He has been following us for three days...

VISHAL

He escaped from the set?

VISHAL'S FATHER

(with scorn in his eyes, looking out the window in disapproval as an old man would)

Escaped? Or was set loose?

DREW

(to Vishal with enthusiasm)

Oh, C'mon! That's gotta be a direct quote from *Lord of the Rings*, right there, bro! I told you man, just like the movies.

VISHAL

Drew, can you please take this seriously man?

We see Drew scribble furiously in his notebook. **Exactly like Lord Of The Rings.**

As fragmented scenes from *Bhang Tour* continue to play out in the room via the astral projection, the vision suddenly turns fuzzy toward the end of the movie. Vishal and Drew are confused and a bit of up-in-arms.

VISHAL (CONT'D)

Wait, wait, wait. What happens at the end? How does it end?!

DREW

Wait, wait, what? Where's the ending? What happens now?

VISHAL'S FATHER

He hasn't written it yet. You see... He's a method writer. He hasn't lived it yet, so he can't write it. We still have a chance to intervene.

DREW

You mean we're going to have to wait to see how it ends?

VISHAL'S FATHER

I'm afraid so.

VISHAL

Wait, he really is a method writer?

VISHAL'S FATHER

A method writer, a method actor, a method everything really. If you keep at it for as long as he has, you sort of become a method liver. My boys, I'm afraid, you have no idea who you are dealing with. And as long as he has possession of that Bong, I'm afraid he will be untouchable.

Terror crosses the face of Vishal and Drew, as we see them both think of every interaction they've had with The C-Lister to date, with a new sense of his character and power.

CUT TO:

FLASHBACK - VARIOUS

A) We see the weed delivery scene from earlier in the movie, but this time, we see The C-Lister stalking the actual weed delivery guy outside of their house, snapping his neck and disposing of the body in the bushes before stealing and wearing his uniform. He takes a large gulp of water before tossing his water in the bushes beside the body, warming up his acting face, and feigning dehydration.

B) We see The C-Lister taking a picture with the Bong, asking the writers to bring it to The Comedy Store.

DREW
(realizing)
He fucking groomed us.

We see a brief image of the Bong Shrine and a slow motion pan of the actor's map behind it. The C-Lister has dedicated his "forgotten years" to following the Bong's path.

C) We see The C-Lister taking a bong rip of DMT at the table with the A-Lister and the writers. We see what he saw during his trip: the others at the table have become ring-wraiths, and the Bong in front of him glows with what appears to be a mix between Sanskrit and Elvish text.

THE WIND (V.O.)
(heard only by The C-
Lister)
Precious...

The C-Lister reaches out for the Bong in vain as it is grabbed by Drew and passed along the circle.

D) We see the The Comedian hate shrine.

E) The C-Lister and Vidu dancing with Willie and the bong at the wedding. From this view, we can see from The C-Lister and Vidu's faces that they are hopeful this may well be the start of some bizarre love triangle.

F) Vishal and Drew both snap out of the flashback, deeply disturbed.

CUT TO:

INT. RISHIKESH ABODE

VISHAL'S FATHER
(strained)
Yes, yes. You must be extremely careful with your gollum. He's probably written you two and your attempts at intervention into the script as well. He'll be prepared. And Vishal, Drew... from here on out, promise me... you will try to be more merciful toward little people. They really are God's greatest gift to us.

We see the astral projection fail as Vishal's father is too drained by the feat to continue.

VISHAL'S FATHER (CONT'D)

I have used all my power. I must rest. You must go, quickly before it is too late... and remember boys, if the bong cannot be protected, it must be destroyed.

Montu lays Vishal's Father in bed and they appear to exchange some words too quiet to hear.

MONTU

(to Vishal)

Your father wishes I come with you, to retrieve the bong, and also, to make sure you stick to canon.

As Vishal and Montu are about to leave, the street dog whimpers and follows Vishal. Vishal has a moment of softness and allows the dog to follow their party out the door.

EXT. RISHIKESH ABODE - SUNSET

Leaving the house, the group sees in the near-distance an INDIAN MOTION CAPTURE ACTOR, skulking behind various boulders and other features of the landscape while making his approach.

MONTU

Good sirs, I believe this is our pursuer.

DREW

(cracking knuckles, hushed,
to the group)

Well, well, well... How do you do, Gollum?

Preparing for a fight, the group is surprised when the man stumbles forward, and they see him to be near death. His skulking, actually all physical pain and anguish.

INDIAN MOTION CAPTURE ACTOR

Please, please. Do you have any water? It's been days.

Vishal and Drew, still freshly traumatized share an uncomfortable look, remembering the same phrase used by the C-Lister earlier. Reluctantly, Vishal hands the advancing man his hydroflask.

As the man drinks the water, he is suddenly pinned to the ground by Drew.

The Indian Motion Capture Actor screams out in pain, a scream that slowly diminishes as Drew begins choking the life out of him.

DREW
(screaming, with rage)
What's the jig, man? Who sent you?
Why have you been following us?
What do you want from us?!

Vishal and Montu run to the altercation, pulling Drew off of the Motion Capture Actor.

VISHAL
Drew! You'll kill him!

Montu holds Drew back with surprising strength as Vishal assures that the man is still alive.

INDIAN MOTION CAPTURE ACTOR
(gasping, slowly regaining
the ability to speak)
I'm here to help you! I'm here to
help!

MONTU
Let him speak.

Dusting himself off and pulling himself toward the nearest rock, the Indian Motion Capture Actor regains his composure, sending a look of disgust toward Drew.

INDIAN MOTION CAPTURE ACTOR
(to Vishal)
Oh thank you, kind sir. Thank you!

The situation now seemingly more under control, Vishal continues with a more gentle inquisition of the Indian Motion Capture Actor now in their capture.

VISHAL
Tell us why you are here.

INDIAN MOTION CAPTURE ACTOR
I escaped his clutches at the
wedding. Oh, how evil that man is.
He may be an amazing director,
actor, writer, and producer, but...
there is something dark about that
man's soul. Pure Hate.

The listeners interest is piqued and they lean in, Drew with a look of distrust painted plainly on his face.

INDIAN MOTION CAPTURE ACTOR (CONT'D)

Oh, yes, sir! Quite an amazing production, honestly. I'm sure even the bad parts will be quite good. But... well, well...

DREW

Well get on with it, you creep!

INDIAN MOTION CAPTURE ACTOR

I didn't think anything of it at the time. Like I said, we were making a beautiful movie:

Progressive casting. Adequate and empowering representation of female characters. An authentically Dhollywood film.

Who wouldn't want to be part of something like that?

VISHAL

Did you see another white girl there? With red hair? Her name is Willie.

INDIAN MOTION CAPTURE ACTOR

Hm. I think so. Yes. He calls her Dix though.

Vishal's fists clench in anger.

VISHAL

(to himself with rage)
That monster.

INDIAN MOTION CAPTURE ACTOR

I can not tell you how excited I was after casting calls, when I found out that I was cast as none other than *THE* one and only Comedian.

VISHAL

(worried)
Wait, he cast you *as the Comedian*?

INDIAN MOTION CAPTURE ACTOR

Oh yes sir, what an honor I thought it was. I deeply respect the comedian's acting abilities and jockey-ing... is that how you say it?

VISHAL

Joking.

INDIAN MOTION CAPTURE ACTOR

His joking skills. He's usually one of the strongest little people on any given film set, you know?

Montu nods in agreement.

INDIAN MOTION CAPTURE ACTOR (CONT'D)

But then he said that I would need to wear this suit in order to capture the *essence* of the part.

The Indian Motion Capture Actor points down at his dirty, bloodied and damaged Motion Capture suit with shame in his eyes.

VISHAL

(examining the man's suit, which is a bit off)

Are those... are those rocks?

Vishal fiddles with a motion capture ball, noticing that they are all, indeed, boulders. By the looks of it, uncomfortably heavy when all added up.

INDIAN MOTION CAPTURE ACTOR

Yes, he said it would get me into character, and build it too...

INDIAN MOTION CAPTURE ACTOR (CONT'D)

(beginning to stumble, emotionally)

There was a scene. He said he was aiming for somewhere between *The Deathly Hallows* and *Red Dragon*.

VISHAL

Oh no...

INDIAN MOTION CAPTURE ACTOR

(having a hard time getting out the words)

He chained me. He beat me. He tortured me. He had it all worked into the script. He justified everything. People were clapping for his performance on the set. It was all, just... it was all so real.

(MORE)

INDIAN MOTION CAPTURE ACTOR (CONT'D)

But he did it in such a way, that the film crew didn't realize it was *actually, physically* happening to me.

DREW

(incredulous, to Vishal)
Are you listening to this? Do you really believe this guy? He's lying to you, Vishal! He's a method actor, just like the rest of them!

VISHAL

(pointing down at the nearly-crippled, suffering man)
Yes, Drew. I... I kinda do believe him.

DREW

(to the Indian Motion Capture Actor, with disbelief)
Why don't you just take off the suit then? Why don't you just leave?

The Indian Motion Capture Actor gestures for the group to lean in. Their mouths drop in horror.

INDIAN MOTION CAPTURE ACTOR

(pointing to the cloth, embedded inside of his skin at various points of his body)
He... he fused it to me.

VISHAL makes the motion to throw up at seeing the surgical site. Montu points his glance toward the ground immediately. Even Drew is taken aback.

INDIAN MOTION CAPTURE ACTOR (CONT'D)

(breaking down, sobbing)
The abuse was too much to take. I thought I was strong... I thought I was strong... But... I'm not. I'm not.

Vishal walks forward and gives the man a hug, as Montu sighs in sympathy and compassion. Drew looks on with suspicion and hatred as his friend embraces the broken man.

Montu, now feeling Drew to be somewhat back under control, un-grips him and approaches the Indian Motion Capture Actor.

MONTU

Tell us about the movie and his plans. We need to know everything...

EXT. SOMEWHERE IN WEST BENGAL - A FIRE PIT

Montu and the Indian Motion Cap Actor have fallen asleep alongside the street dog, who is still wearing Vishal's mo-cap suit. We join Vishal and Drew as they lay next to a camp fire en route to the Ganges.

VISHAL

Do you think we'll ever see her again, Drew?

DREW

I'm sure we will, man. That bastard's not gonna let her far from his sight.

A moment passes.

VISHAL

I don't want to think about what she must be going through.

DREW

I know. He's probably putting his dirty old lips all over her mouthpiece. Sucking it all out of her in one go.

VISHAL

(horrified)

What are you talking about, man?!

DREW

You're talking about the Bong, Right?

VISHAL

No man, Willie!

DREW

Oh! Right... I'm sure she's fine man.

An awkward and unconfident moment passes, and Drew decides to change the subject back to the bong.

DREW (CONT'D)

Fair bit of irony though that he's turned us all into figurative Gollums, chasing after him and the bong. Almost makes you wonder if he's actually the good guy.

Drew writes in his notebook, "The C-Lister = Good? / Bad?"

VISHAL

I assure you, he's not the good guy here, man! He's trafficking our friend!

DREW

Sounds like he's taking things in a really strong direction artistically though, from what I've been hearing.

VISHAL

What do you mean from what you've been hearing? You've been next to me since we woke up in the field.

DREW

(a beat)

You know what I mean. He's got a lot going for him right now. He's working based off of our material, after all.

VISHAL

(snapping)

Hey, listen! I don't want to talk about his rip-off screenplay except for what we need to do to stop it, alright?

DREW

I'm not sure anybody could stop him, much less, us.

VISHAL

We *have* to stop him.

DREW

Why? Are we jealous?

VISHAL

Why on earth would we be jealous?

DREW
(quickly, exhibiting what
appears to be mild
psychosis)
He stoles its from us, he did.

Drew wrings his hands together compulsively.

VISHAL
Hey, wait a minute. You're right!
He did steal our shit, didn't he?

DREW
He fucking stole our bong, and
snagged our script, dude, right out
from under our fucking noses.

VISHAL
How did we not see this coming?

DREW
Right?

Vishal and Drew look up toward the night skyline, which suddenly features several newly plastered ads (more being made in real-time, almost at hyper-speed) promoting the C-Lister's upcoming feature film release: **Bhang Tour**. Drew is impressed by the sheer number of billboards now spanning the horizon.

DREW (CONT'D)
Looks like he really has a solid
grip on the bong at this point too.

VISHAL
(stammering)
Well... What should we do then?

DREW
Well, I do have one idea.

A short silence occurs. Drew leans in whispers something that leaves Vishal looking not particularly impressed.

VISHAL
That's your idea?

DREW
Do you have a better one?

VISHAL
Not really.

VISHAL (CONT'D)

(sighing)

I just wish Willie was here, she'd know what to do.

DREW

Dude, she'd be suggesting we do the same damn thing.

VISHAL

Not so sure about that... She's edited out a lot of our bad ideas before.

DREW

Do you even know that girl, man? What do you think she's doing, waiting around for your ass to come save her? You don't even know how to wield a cricket bat, dude.

Vishal again looks down in shame.

DREW (CONT'D)

There's no way she's sitting back and just taking it from him. He's like, geriatric, man. If anything, she's sabotaging his script from the inside, think about it.

VISHAL

That does seem more like her.

DREW

And she'd be thinking - what are my dumbass friends gonna come up with when it comes time for them to try and stop him?

VISHAL

Okay... And?

DREW

And we can't out-think ourselves, dude! Whatever we do next has to be just as dumb and reckless as she would be expecting us to be.

VISHAL

Are you sure she doesn't want us to be smart?

DREW

This *is* being smart. Trust me dude,
it's gonna work.

VISHAL

Alright then, so, what do we do
once we get there?

DREW

We get our fucking bong back dude,
have you not been listening?

VISHAL

Well then... We ride at dawn!

CUT TO:

EXT. A DHOLLYWOOD FANTASY SET AT THE FOOT OF THE GANGES, IN
FRONT OF A PALACE - WEST BENGAL

Filming is in progress at the C-Lister's set. The Hollywood
Little Person (Vidu aka Frodo) is shoeless and dirty, but
otherwise wearing full and tastefully conceived traditional
Indian attire. The C-Lister (Dhruv aka Samwise) is seen in
similar costuming and condition.

The C-Lister is both directing and acting, holding a hand-
held camera with what appears to be a rich man's selfie-
stick.

VIDU AKA FRODO

I wish the Bhang had never come to
me. I wish none of this had
happened.

DHRUV AKA SAMWISE

I made a promise Vidu. 'Don't Leave
Him, Dhruv'. And I don't mean to! I
don't mean to!

Vidu stands amid swirling smoke and cinematic chaos. He turns
to Dhruv, eyes distant, lips trembling.

VIDU

I'm glad you're here, Dhruv. I
can't recall the taste of food...
nor the sound of water... nor the
scent of grass. I'm naked in the
dark - no veil between me and the
ring of fire.

The Bhang was entrusted to me.

(MORE)

VIDU (CONT'D)
It's my task.
Mine! My own!

INT. TUK-TUK - SPEEDING THROUGH KOLKATA STREETS - SAME TIME

Drew and Vishal bounce violently in the back of a tuk-tuk. A street dog in a mo-cap suit lies across their laps, panting. Montu drives like a maniac. In the front passenger seat, the Indian Motion Capture Actor looms large next to tiny Montu.

EXT. DHOLLYWOOD FANTASY SET - CONTINUOUS

Dhruv kneels, overcome with emotion.

DHRUV
I know. It's all wrong.

By rights, we shouldn't even be here. But we are.

It's like in the great films, Mr. Vidu...

The Kubricks, the Hitchcocks.

Those were the stories that stayed with you... that meant something.

Even if you were too... small to understand why.

INT. TUK-TUK - CONTINUOUS

Vishal fumbles with his phone. It buzzes - an incoming call:

Maybe: The A-Lister

He hesitates and then ignores it.

EXT. FANTASY SET - CONTINUOUS

VIDU
I don't think I'm going to be returning.

He takes a massive swig from a brass thermos labeled: BHANG LASSI - "For Spiritual Use Only."

EXT. STREETS / VARIOUS BILLBOARDS - INTERCUT

We see massive billboards rising above the chaos. Each one features the C-Lister in heroic poses.

"THE C-LISTER IS BACK" - Pinkvilla
 "A TRIUMPH OF MODERN CINEMA" - Film
 Companion

"Bhang Tour is PURE CINEMATIC
 BRAVERY" - Bollywood Hungama

Somehow, despite the movie not being done, The C-Lister has been very busy.

EXT. FANTASY SET - CONTINUOUS

DHRUV
 I know, Mr. Vidu...
 We are going to take a very long
 road...
 into darkness.
 But I know I can't turn back.

He notices Vidu wavering.

DHRUV (CONT'D)
 (gently)
 Mr. Vidu?
 Mr. Vidu?

Vidu is *completely* blasted. He sways slightly... then slumps, eyes glazed, high beyond return.

EXT. APPROACHING SET - CONTINUOUS

The tuk-tuk barrels toward the set - now just twenty meters away. Nobody's slowing down.

Inside:

DREW
 Dude. Dude! He's not braking!

VISHAL
 He doesn't know how!

EXT. FANTASY SET - CONTINUOUS

DHRUV
I might not be able to carry it for
you...
but I can carry you!

Dhruv hoists Vidu dramatically onto his shoulders.

EXT. SET - CONTINUOUS

Suddenly - CRASH!

Montu's tuk-tuk slams into the set full-speed, obliterating half the rigging. Crew members scream. Fake trees fly. The only security guard is instantly killed by a rogue boom pole.

PURE CHAOS.

Spilling out of the tuk-tuk, Drew and Vishal spot the Bong right next to the director's chair, nod to one another, and make a break for it.

They are intercepted by two very large and formidable men. One, a roided-out Russian, and another a robust Indian man, both wielding swords, ready to beat the shit out of or dismember anything that walks.

VISHAL	DREW
(confused)	(perplexed)
Who the fuck are you guys?	Who the fuck are you guys?

INDIAN
(approaching Vishal, thick
accent)
I'm the co-writer of *Bhang Tour*.
Vishal.

RUSSIAN
(approaching Drew, thick
accent)
I'm the co-writer of *Bhang Tour*.
Drew.

VISHAL	DREW
Holy Shit!	Oh, fuck that!

Two PRODUCTION ASSISTANTS deliver Vishal & Drew each a cricket bat, give a friendly smile toward the Russian and Indian bodybuilders, and make motions to other crew to begin filming the action.

CUT TO:

The C-Lister, momentarily breaking out of character - surveys the damage of the set. He has dropped Vidu off of his back. Half out of habit, half out of insecurity, he looks for the Bong and smiles when he sees that it is unscathed. Out of the corner of his eye, he spots the Indian Motion Capture Actor exiting the flame-surrounded tuk-tuk, and his face transforms instantly with unbridled rage.

THE C-LISTER
 (ghoulishly, violence in
 his eyes)
 It's a good day to die, Comedian!

The Indian Motion Capture Actor sees the C-Lister and fear quakes across his face. He hobbles off-camera hurriedly as the C-Lister pursues him in a rage.

Coming out of his bhang daze, Vidu sees Montu surreptitiously making his way toward the director's chair, his gaze fixed upon the Bong.

Unseen to Montu, Vidu rises from his slumber, cracks his knuckles and removes his shirt, revealing him to be incredibly ripped.

VIDU
 (pep-spoken to himself,
 while warming up with
 intense and well-executed
 martial arts)
 Oh no you don't, little man.

CUT TO:

EXT. SHORE OF THE SACRED GANGES RIVER

The C-Lister's writers corner Drew and Vishal at the bank of the Ganges and begin to attack them. Being in Dhollywood, the C-Lister's writer's fighting styles are outlandish and unusual, and it's not a stretch by any means to say they're wielding superhuman abilities. The heroes' cricket bats are clearly no match for their adversaries swords, and are being hacked into nothing more than sticks.

Drew and Vishal are clearly outmatched, but a ray of hope is mutually understood when they see the Indian Motion Capture Actor approaching their assailants from behind. Their hope is quickly extinguished as their attackers move, revealing that the Indian Motion Capture Actor is being led to the shoreline upon a leash clasped securely by the C-Lister.

THE C-LISTER
 (feeding the Indian Motion
 Capture actor a cookie)
 Nice work. Brought them right to
 us, just like we planned.

Drew and Vishal look at each other in dismay, ditch the
 hacked-away cricket bats and attempt to parry the incoming
 attacks with increasingly battered improvised objects they
 have found along the shoreline.

VISHAL
 (heartbroken, to the Indian
 Motion Capture Actor)
 You betrayed us!

DREW
 I fucking knew it.

INDIAN MOTION CAPTURE ACTOR
 (ashamed)
 I'm so, so, so, sorry.

INT. PALACE ALONG SHORE OF GANGES

Despite his advancing age, Montu is adept at countering
 Vidu's attacks. The display is world-class, and it is clear
 that they are both of at least black-belt level in their
 respective fighting styles.

VIDU
 I'm impressed. Where did you learn
 to fight like this?

Montu blocks the incoming attacks with expertise.

MONTU
 I'm self-taught, you might say.

In a former life, I was a...

Vidu attempts a choke-hold, which Montu reverses, putting the
 Hollywood Little person in a counter-grab.

MONTU (CONT'D)
 method actor.

EXT. SHORE OF THE SACRED GANGES RIVER

The heroes are losing their fight, badly. Worse yet, we see
 that the C-Lister is getting amazing footage with a handheld-
 camera.

He's managing to direct the movie seamlessly while the chaos unfolds. Various key grips and camera-people are seen performing their jobs on-set with enthusiasm, as if nothing is amiss.

In spite of their best efforts at countering the skilled fighter's blows, Drew is ultimately stabbed and falls onto his adversary's sword and falls backward to the ground. Vishal sees his friend's fate as he himself is thrown to the ground.

Vishal begins being choked out by his assailant.

VISHAL
(fading)
Nooooo!

Time slows, as music reminiscent of *Gladiator* plays. In an inspired feat, Vishal grasps at the beach sand and throws it in his adversary's eyes. With his enemy blinded, Vishal steals his opponent's sword and beheads him, before proceeding to behead Drew's unsuspecting attacker from behind.

VISHAL (CONT'D)
Just like in *Highlander*,
motherfucker.

DREW
(stabbed, yet supportively)
Nice.

The C-Lister drops the leash from his hand and kicks the Indian Motion Capture Actor to the ground, disabling him further. Approaching the shoreline, we can see The C-Lister is still filming, and is heard excitedly giving play-by-play of the shot:

THE C-LISTER
Hot damn! TWO on-screen murders!
That's Hitchcock level!

The C-Lister comes in for a close-up of Drew and Vishal, both covered in blood. A sword still sticks up from Drew's abdomen at a 90 degree angle.

THE C-LISTER (CONT'D)
(devilishly)
Isn't being a method writer the
greatest?

The C-Lister proceeds to drive the sword further into Drew and the sand below, before pulling it out and wielding the weapon, handheld camera still in his strong hand.

DREW
 (coughing up blood)
 Vishal was right... you're a
 fucking psychopath!

Vishal, looking at the C-Lister with contempt, begins to advance toward him --- brandishing his sword with murderous intent.

They begin sword-fighting. It is apparent that the C-Lister has had training, and is doing an outstanding job with his off-hand against a weakened Vishal, all-the-while still filming.

During a moment where the C-Lister's blade is dead-locked with Vishal's, the C-Lister proceeds to bite Vishal's shoulder, causing Vishal to drop the sword and begin frothing from the mouth. The C-Lister cackles as blood flows down his face.

His maniacal laughter is only broken by Drew's slow, loud, rolling laughter.

DREW (CONT'D)
 (pointing upward)
 Gollum... You've lost.

The C-Lister looks upward to see Vidu climbing up into the rafters with the Bong, being trailed at a few length's distance by Montu, all signs of animosity removed. Various cameramen and key grips are seen to be still following them to the rafters, filming the action.

THE C-LISTER
 (exasperated)
 What in the flying fuck?

THE C-LISTER (CONT'D)
 (shouting)
 To the winding stairs!

The C-Lister bolts toward a winding staircase leading to the rafters where the little people have absconded. The rafters lead up into the main dome of the palace, where the stage lights are being held. In all the chaos, one of the stage lights falls onto the already burning tuk-tuk below and explodes, throwing fire everywhere. The scene in the rafters calls to mind *Mount Doom*.

We watch in slow-motion as the little people cross the rafters. Vidu approaches the edge of the catwalk, with the bong extended in his hand.

Vidu stares intently at the Bong, hanging over the fire below. Vidu appears lost in the Bong's shimmer and gleam.

THE WIND (V.O.)
(heard only by Vidu,
haunting whispers)
Precious.

MONTU
(shouting from behind Vidu
on the catwalk)
What are you waiting for? Just
destroy it! Throw it in the fire!

After a moment's pause, Vidu turns toward Montu, with the Bong still in hand.

VIDU
(coldly)
The Bong is mine.

A spark from a white lighter is more heard than seen, and we slowly pan to see a close-up of Vidu lighting up a bowl and taking a massive hit. As he draws the smoke in, The C-Lister appears from seemingly out of nowhere, sword drawn, fangs bearing, and jumps on Vidu's back. The C-Lister rips the bong away from Vidu by way of biting off his finger.

Bong now in hand, the C-Lister propels corrosive bong water onto the face of Montu before stabbing him with his sword, causing Montu to writhe in pain and fall backward onto the catwalk.

The C-Lister begins dancing triumphantly in true Gollum fashion. The now missing-fingered Vidu, seeing this attack on his new friend, erupts in anger, using his martial arts to disarm the C-Lister.

Vidu catches the C-Lister's sword and dives toward The C-Lister, who is still dancing with the Bong, impaling him and sending them both off the edge of the catwalk.

Drew and Vishal, maimed and bleeding, witness the scene, and while lying down, are heard arguing semantics.

DREW
(in total agony, making the
best of the situation)
Just like *Lord of The Rings*, dude.

VISHAL
(diplomatically, foam still
trailing from his mouth)
Very similar.

Atop the catwalk, we see that Montu though bleeding badly, is alive, crawling toward the precipice of the catwalk the C-Lister and Vidu have just fallen from. When Montu arrives at the edge, we see Vidu hanging from the catwalk by his remaining fingers.

Montu grabs Vidu's arm to pull him up, but we can see that Vidu is distracted. Just out of his sword's reach, on a ledge above the burning fire below, rests the Bong, still in perfect condition.

VIDU
I can reach it.

Vidu attempts to grab one of the Bong's loops on his sword.

MONTU
Vidu. Let it go.
Vidu, Let it go.

Vidu, looking crazed, hooks his sword within a loop of the Bong, but in so doing causes Montu to lose his grip, the sword hoists the Bong upward toward the catwalk, while Vidu falls downward into the fire.

After following an amazing trajectory, the Bong lands in Montu's now-free hand, which we see close in a fist around it as the fire below causes the rafter to come crashing down.

We see random set-members still filming & clapping at the performance.

Amongst the smoldering wreckage, we see multiple crews filming as we pan over the mangled bodies of crew-members, to see Montu slowly regain consciousness.

Badly hurt, Montu begins crawling toward the river with the perfectly preserved Bong still in hand. He fills the Bong with water from The Ganges, and collecting his strength, hobbles toward Drew. He pours the water onto Drew's wounds which heal instantly. He crawls toward Vishal and pours Bong Water onto his bloodied shoulder. Vishal stops foaming from the mouth and his wound closes, as Montu collapses next to him.

Vishal, recovering after a few moments, looks to his side and sees Montu has stopped breathing. He grabs the Bong from beside the little person and pours water onto his wounds, healing the most dire. Montu gasps with refreshment and new life as Vishal also has him drink the water from the Bong.

Vishal rolls over and collapses in exhaustion and we see the camera shift from foreground to background.

A bit of time passes as the heroes rest on the ground, regaining their strength.

DREW
(looking upward at the sky)
Exactly like *The Last Crusade*, man.
Exactly!

VISHAL
(also looking upward,
peacefully)
That was pretty fucking close, I'll
admit.

INDIAN MOTION CAPTURE ACTOR (V.O.)
(off-screen, feebly)
Is anybody going to heal me?

Beyond the smoke rising from the fires nearby, a helicopter appears in the distance. Upon landing, the heroes see the A-Lister and the Comedian disembark the aircraft.

Drew sits up with a renewed but enfeebled constitution.

DREW
Oh, Thank God.

As the A-Lister approaches, Vishal remains laying down looking at the sky, absorbing all that has just occurred. We see the Comedian grab The C-Lister's hand-held camera from the wreckage. He fumbles with the controls a bit, turning the camera's view-screen a few different directions before figuring it out.

THE COMEDIAN
Hey look! It's still recording.

Montu, still clutching the Bong, sees the A-Lister standing over him.

THE A-LISTER
(in a friendly tone)
You okay, bud? That was a close
call. Huh?

Montu smiles in relief. The A-Lister extends a hand to help him up, but goes for the hand holding the Bong rather than Montu's now extended hand. Montu's face is suddenly filled with distrust. As the A-Lister looks over the battle-wearied little person, he again attempts to grab the Bong from him. A struggle ensues, and the A-Lister grabs for Vishal's sword, laying beside him.

Face to face with Montu beneath, the A-Lister puts his leg into the little person's sternum, pinning him.

THE A-LISTER (CONT'D)
 (mostly to himself,
 somewhat philosophically)
 Funny how method writing works.
 Only now... at the end, do I see
 why the midget has to die.

The A-Lister coldly stabs Montu with the sword. The Comedian licks his chops with pleasure watching the scene unfold. With the Bong now in hand, the A-Lister pulls the sword from Montu, and turns toward the Comedian to celebrate.

	VISHAL		DREW
Noooo!!!		Noooo!!!	

THE A-LISTER
 Tell me you got that!!! An on-
 screen midget murder. Can you
 believe it? I'm totally
 Hitchcocking this shit.

THE COMEDIAN
 I think I got it!

THE A-LISTER
 (laughing maniacally,
 nervously)
 You better have! I don't want to
 have to do it again!

THE COMEDIAN
 (in cinematic awe)
 I know he tried... but I don't even
 think Hitchcock ever managed to
 successfully pull it off with a
 midget. This? This may just be a
film first.

DREW
 You Monster!

Drew lunges toward the A-Lister, causing the Bong to fall from the A-Lister's grip and back into the reach of the again-wounded Montu. Drew's attack catches The A-Lister by surprise, and Drew, for the first time in all of the fighting, has the upper-hand. He kicks the A-Lister to the ground.

DREW (CONT'D)
 Guess there's a little Bong in all
 of us.

Seeing his friend in trouble, The Comedian sets down the camera on a table beside him and removes his shirt, revealing that he is incredibly ripped.

DREW (CONT'D)
(stammering)
Why is everybody fucking ripped?!

After a few quick warm up moves, the Comedian comes to the A-Lister's aid, beating the shit out of Drew, who finds he is quickly outmatched by the Comedian's superior control of martial arts.

Meanwhile, Vishal is using Drew's distraction to drag Montu toward the river. The A-Lister, now unloosed from Drew's attack, spots him and attempts to intervene. Vishal runs toward him to delay him, but is pushed back toward the ground before being stabbed in the leg and pinned down by the A-Lister's sword.

THE A-LISTER
(driving the sword deep
into the sand below
Vishal's leg, with a
sadistic look in his eyes)
I hate to do this, sweet Vishal.
Orders from Upper Management.

Vishal stammers as the A-Lister begins walking past him toward Montu and the Bong. Out of the corner of his eye, Vishal sees that Drew is incapacitated and bloodied within an inch of his life. He realizes they haven't given Montu the time he needs to reach the river.

With hope all but lost, we see Vishal stare deep into the eyes of The Indian Motion Capture Actor lying crippled in the near-distance. The Indian Motion Capture Actor responds by pointing at himself questioningly.

Vishal points at the Indian Motion Capture Actor's suit and nods a knowing nod. He gestures as though throwing a baseball.

The Indian Motion Capture looks puzzled for a moment until --
- *Eureka!* He nods back at Vishal, pulls a rock off of his suit, and winds up his arm.

Following the rock's remarkable course through bodies and debris, we see it eventually strike a pyrotechnics control switch that looks uncannily like a cricket wicket. The flurry of explosions and fireworks force the Comedian and the A-Lister to drop their pursuits and take cover.

DREW
(nearly dead, in awe)

LAGAAN...

With explosions occurring in the background behind him, Montu finishes his labored crawl toward the river, grabbing various rubbish from the explosions along the way that he fashions into a basket. The scene ends how the movie began, only this time we can see that Vishal is just in shot. Montu releases the Bong into the Ganges and lays in the shallow, slowly dying.

In the tail-end of the disarray, Vishal painfully removes the sword from his leg, and drags himself toward Montu on the shoreline, tears streaming down his face. The Bong is just out of Vishal's reach. He attempts to crawl toward it, his upper body briefly entering the river, but Montu extends his hand and grabs Vishal's unharmed ankle, stopping his advancement.

MONTU
The Bong can only preserve life. It
cannot extend it.

VISHAL
(crawling back onto shore,
weeping)
No...

As the light in Montu's eyes fades, Vishal closes them.

The A-Lister approaches the river, stepping over Montu and Vishal in an attempt to retrieve the Bong, but as he is about to step into the water itself, he is stopped by the sudden arrival of WEST BANGLADESHI POLICE FORCES, who are closing down the production due to the escalating disaster unfolding.

Being restrained from further advancement by various police personnel, we see a wide shot of the A-Lister screaming.

THE A-LISTER
(to a confused officer)
That's film set property! Do you
hear me? I need to retrieve it!

THE A-LISTER (CONT'D)
(frustrated)
You don't understand a fucking word
I'm saying, do you?

(shouting around)
Can I get a translator over here?

A very official & serious police officer, INSPECTOR DABAANG, approaches the A-Lister. The A-Lister begins to speak to to the on-comer who has been summoned, assuming him to be another underling.

THE A-LISTER (CONT'D)

Oh, good. Finally! Listen, we had some equipment fall into the river. I just need to grab that. It's studio property.

INSPECTOR DABAANG

Excuse me, sir! I am Inspector Dabaang. Are you the one in charge here? Tell me what happened.

The A-Lister looks around nervously at the burning wreckage around him, and sensing he may be financially and criminally at risk, begins backpedaling.

THE A-LISTER

Well, um, I'm technically just, um, a method actor, a method writer.

Dabaang looks at the A-Lister, confused at his response. His scrutiny and suspicion of the A-Lister seem to increase with every second.

THE A-LISTER (CONT'D)

A spectator, really. Here on sabbatical. Just visiting.

INSPECTOR DABAANG

(taking a few notes)

Ah yes, I see. Well, unfortunately, it is impossible for you to enter the river. This particular film permit does not have the proper rights to the river. I can't let you enter.

THE A-LISTER

Are you fucking kidding me? Are you telling me we didn't get the rights to the river? We *had* to have gotten permits to the river. The whole fucking movie is about the river. I just need to get this one thing...

INSPECTOR DABAANG

We, sir?

THE A-LISTER

Um... He. I meant, he... the guy responsible for this... I think his name was... shit, what was his name?

The A-Lister looks frazzled, but then notices a billboard for *Bhang Tour* in the near distance and points toward it.

Inspector Dabaang looks up at the billboard but immediately brings his eyes to the floor upon seeing the C-Lister's face & likeness.

INSPECTOR DABAANG

(reverently, in Bengali)

Shaat Boner Shourya Dev Singh.

SUBTITLES

The Divine Lion of Valor from the Seven Forests.

SUBTITLES (IN HINDI):

Saath jungleon ka chhaya hua raja, jiske haathon mein camera tha aur dil mein paaniyon ka dard.

(The shadowed king of seven forests, who held a camera in his hand and the sorrow of rivers in his heart)

INSPECTOR DABAANG

Yes, Shaat Boner is the man I took the bribe from for the filming rights to this palace. He told me that he was just the screenwriter, director, and talent, and that you, sir were the film's producer.

INSPECTOR DABAANG produces a permit with a photograph of the A-Lister paper-clipped to the top. In the picture, he is shaking hands with the C-Lister on the day of casting calls.

We see the fine print state that the signer will be legally responsible for all conduct on-set.

INSPECTOR DABAANG (CONT'D)

(surveying the damage)

You will, of course, be totally liable for all damages.

THE A-LISTER

(nervously)

Well... um... about that...

INSPECTOR DABAANG

(interrupting, reverently)

You have a great honor to be working for Shaat Boner, sir. A true visionary in every sense of the word. Very progressive. To say he is culturally sensitive would be a tremendous understatement.

I have never met a man with more artistic integrity. I assured him that nothing would happen to his movie under my watch, and he promised he would not make a mockery of our most sacred river as it appears you and these other...

The inspector surveys the shoreline littered with bodies and carnage.

INSPECTOR DABAANG (CONT'D)

(with scorn)

"method actors" have done so here today.

INDIAN MOTION CAPTURE ACTOR (V.O.)

(in agony, off-screen)

Please... help me.

RANDOM BANGELDASHI POLICE PERSON (V.O)

A few people are still alive under the wreckage!

INSPECTOR DABAANG

(to the A-Lister)

Now if you'll excuse me, I have lives to save. Don't go too far, though. By the honor of my word to Shaat Boner, and on my mother's grave, I'm going to get to the bottom of what happened here.

We remain in the stationary wide shot. The A-Lister slowly skirts away from Dabaang and begins making calls and shouting incredulously into the phone.

THE A-LISTER

Can you believe it? I know. I know. Looks like our Gollum had a deal on the back end with Lucas to drop the river in using CGI.

OTHER LINE

(inaudible)

THE A-LISTER

Right? What happened to artistic integrity? That's what I've been saying all along.

OTHER LINE

(inaudible)

THE A-LISTER

Well, well, I sure as hell don't want to explain the missing bong to Upper Management. I... I can't get kicked off the list. Just, just... let me get ahead of this, I have another idea.

THE A-LISTER (CONT'D)

(to himself, cutting the phone)

Execution is everything.

Drew, bloodied and haggard, manages to stumble over to Vishal and their dearly departed friend. He joins Vishal in weeping.

The A-Lister paces in frustration up and down the shoreline, before finally coming to the young men. Looking up and down at Montu's bloodied corpse, the A-Lister approaches.

THE A-LISTER (CONT'D)

Sweet, sweet Lilliput. You left us too soon.

The A-Lister twiddles his thumbs nervously together before performing a quick hail-mary and putting his arms around the shell-shocked writers.

THE A-LISTER (CONT'D)

So listen up guys, it's looking more and more like we have an international incident on our hands here. We got all the footage we needed. What a great ending, huh? You guys really pulled through for us. It's probably best we do the rest in post back stateside. We'll CGI in everything else we didn't get from the India team.

THE A-LISTER (CONT'D)

(shouting into the distance, to The Comedian)

Did you grab all the cameras? We ready to go?

We can see that the Comedian, still shirtless, has taken the pilot's seat of the helicopter. With a camera in hand, all-the-while filming, he gives the A-Lister a thumbs up. Seeing both of the writers are clearly in shock, the A-Lister removes his shirt, revealing him to also be incredibly ripped.

The A-Lister ties his shirt around Vishal's leg to stop the bleeding, collects Drew and Vishal's injured bodies, and hoisting both of them over his back, loads them into the helicopter.

As the Comedian fires up the helicopter, we see Drew & Vishal laid out, struggling to process their reality.

THE A-LISTER (CONT'D)
(with a self-satisfied grin
on his face)
Man, there is nothing better on
this earth than method living, am I
right, or what, fellas? It really
is the only way to make a movie.

The A-Lister slaps Vishal's wounded leg as a gesture of friendship, causing Vishal to bellow in pain.

The A-Lister lingers outside, still feeling like the king of the world.

He straightens his ripped torso, takes a deep breath of the humid air, and smiles.

THE A-LISTER (CONT'D)
This, my friends, is gonna be a
cash machine.

He turns toward the helicopter, ready to step inside—

A CRICKET BAT SWINGS INTO FRAME, BLOCKING HIS PATH.

The A-Lister stumbles back, startled.

WILLIE (O.S.)
You shall not pass!

EXT. SHORELINE - WIDE SHOT

The camera whips to Willie, standing at the helicopter door, cricket bat in hand.

The wind from the rotor blows her hair back, making her look like an absolute legend.

The A-Lister laughs uncomfortably, trying to step forward again.

THE A-LISTER
Oh-ho, okay. Cute. Let's not get
all dramatic. Just let me hop in-

SHE SWINGS THE BAT AGAIN, STOPPING HIM MID-STEP.

WILLIE
(stern)
This is where you get off.

The A-Lister blinks.

He glances at Vishal and Drew inside the helicopter.

They stare back at him.

Their expressions have changed. They're not just reacting anymore.

Vishal & Drew are both filming with hand-held cameras. The Comedian seems to be getting alternate angles with his own camera, suddenly in total cahoots with the heroes.

The A-Lister laughs nervously, looking at them.

THE A-LISTER
Guys? C'mon, tell her to move.

The A-Lister pales. He looks at Willie, at the bat, at Vishal and Drew- And suddenly, he gets it. For the first time, he realizes he has lost control.

EXT. SHORELINE - WIDE SHOT

The A-Lister lunges forward-

Willie swings the cricket bat one last time, smacking the door shut in his face.

Drew and Vishal exchange a look.

Drew tilts his head. Smirks.

DREW
Oh man... Vishal...

VISHAL
For real. *Lord of the Rings*, dude.

The Comedian, still filming, gives a massive grin and a thumbs-up.

THE A-LISTER

Wait— you're turning on me?

The Comedian lowers the camera, considering.

Then, with a shrug—

THE COMEDIAN

Method living, right?

He tilts the camera for one last cinematic shot—without the A-Lister.

The helicopter lifts off, leaving the A-Lister behind.

Willie leans against the door, watching as they fly away.

Below, the A-Lister stands alone, shirtless in the dirt, staring in utter disbelief.

As they soar over the landscape—

Drew and Vishal collapse back, finally exhaling.

The wind rushes through the open doors, lifting The C-Lister's scattered script pages into the air.

Willie sits with the cricket bat in her lap, watching Vishal.

He glances at her.

She produces a bound, polished script.

VISHAL

(stunned)

Is that...?

DREW

The final version?

Willie smirks.

WILLIE

The extended, director's cut...

WILLIE (CONT'D)

One script to rule them all.

Willie raises it slightly and they see the print:

**BONG TOUR
A MASALA FILM**

Vishal and Drew grin stupid grins as their eyes close and we:

FADE TO BLACK.

CREDITS ROLL

We see scenes from the released Bong Tour, and its outtakes, as an audience would. A movie inside a movie.

FADE IN:

We see Vishal & Drew and Willie leaving the premier of *Bong Tour* in Hollywood. In a scene harkening back to his Father's film premier, they sign autographs for adoring fans. Bong Tour is clearly well beloved by all who see it. It has changed lives.

As they wave their goodbyes to their fans, they turn the corner to get into their limo, when a man in darkness begins lighting a cigarette with a *White Lighter*. He speaks to them from the darkness. It's the voice of:

UPPER MANAGEMENT CONTACT

Hey, you kids make a pretty good
movie... Thought about a sequel?

A hand extends from the darkness to present Vishal and Drew a business card that reads: Upper Management.